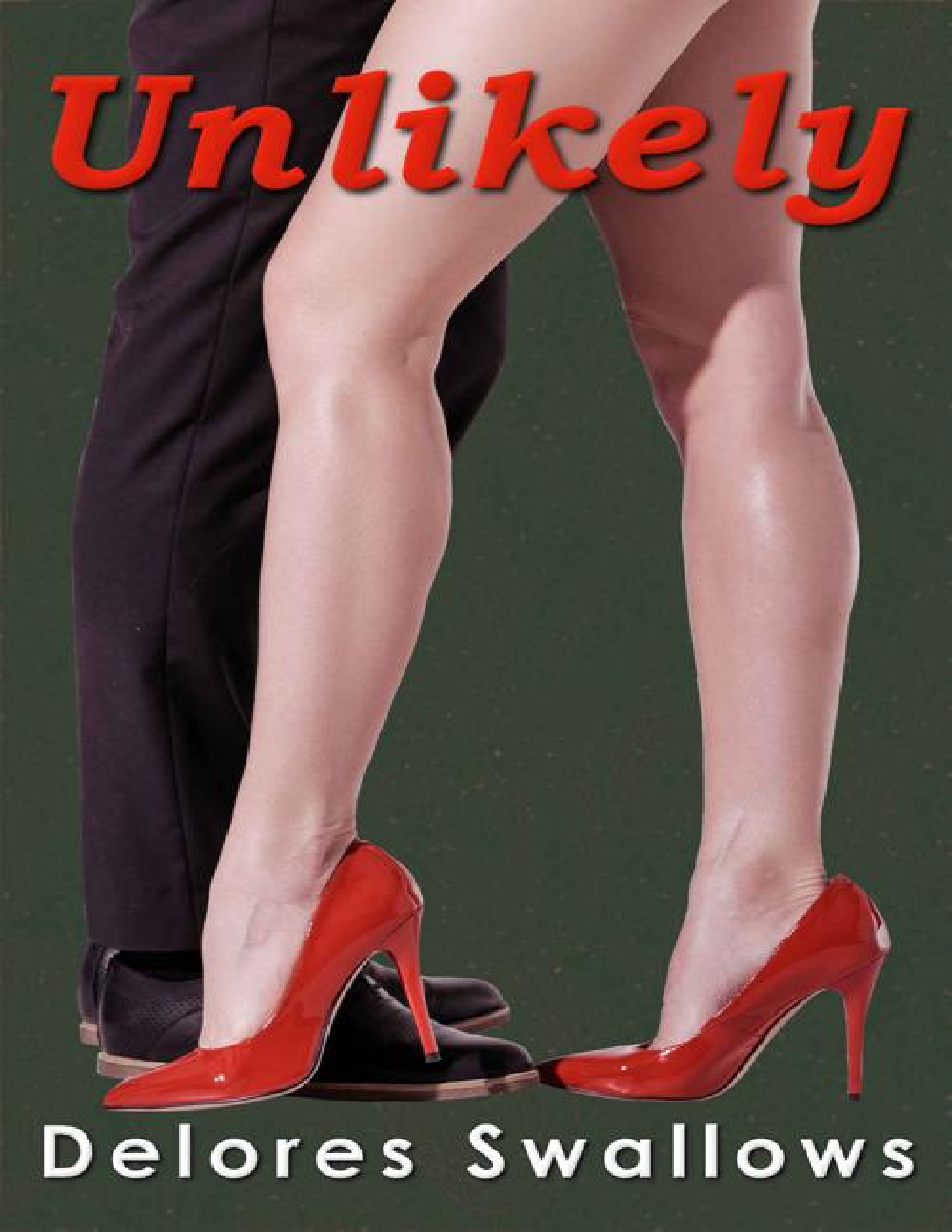


A photograph showing the lower legs and feet of a man and a woman. The woman is wearing bright red, glossy high-heeled pumps. The man is wearing dark trousers and dark-colored shoes. They are standing on a dark green surface.

Unlikely

Delores Swallows

Unlikely

When Opposites Attract

by Delores Swallows

Delores Swallows Publications

[Web](#) | [Twitter](#) | [Amazon](#)

**Sign up for FREE stories and MORE
from Delores Swallows**

[Join Delores' Mailing List](#)

This book is a work of fiction. Names, characters, places, and incidents either are products of the author's imagination or are used fictitiously. Any resemblance to actual events or locales or persons, living or dead, is entirely coincidental.

Copyright © 2016 Delores Swallows

Kindle Edition, License Notes

All rights reserved. No part of this book may be reproduced in any form or by any electronic or mechanical means—except in the case of brief quotations embodied in articles or reviews—without written permission from its publisher.

Content Advisory: This book is intended for mature audiences and contains explicit sexual activity.

Unlikely

Four erotic encounters involving people who wouldn't be expected to interact.

Maggie's always had a thing for bad-boys. While working as a defence lawyer, she finds herself in a position to give serial-offender Sean more than just legal counsel...

Inexperienced student Max knows that his friend's larger-than-life neighbour Sheila has four children with four different fathers. But while waiting for his friend to get home, Sheila shows him there are better ways to spend his time than playing computer games...

Joanna's been looking forward to their friends' wedding for a long time. She's worked hard to get her figure back, found the perfect outfit and arranged a babysitter. Her husband decides to drink so much he passes out, but she realises her own evening doesn't have to be ruined, thanks to the Maître d'...

Leanne should be enjoying the perfect life—successful husband, beautiful daughter, nice house and car, regular exotic holidays. When she meets Doug, an obnoxious labourer at her daughter's riding school, he wonders what's missing from her life to make her so bitter. Then he puts his finger on it. In fact, he puts more than his finger on it. Leanne realises he's probably not a labourer, and finds he's actually not that obnoxious...

A collection of hot short stories that show just how strongly opposites attract.

Contents



Unlikely

[Unjust Rewards](#)

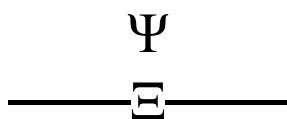
[The Bigger Picture](#)

[Wedding Belles](#)

[Unbridled Passion](#)

[ABOUT THE AUTHOR](#)

[ALSO BY DELORES SWALLOWS](#)



Unjust Rewards

Maggie strolled into the office, smiling at Carol as she passed through reception. Jake was already at his desk. “Hey, Jake. How come you’re in so early?”

“In court this morning.” He looked up from his notes and smiled. “Nice shoes.”

There was no subtlety about the way Jake ran his eyes over her body, and this was one of the reasons why Maggie liked him. Being the only female lawyer under thirty in their practice had a lot of benefits, so she was happy to accept there were also some negatives. The main negative was Lawrence, one of the senior partners. The old bugger never failed to ‘brush’ past her when there was acres of space, or rub his clammy fingers along hers when handing her papers.

“Thanks.”

She was genuinely pleased he’d noticed the shoes, but glad he hadn’t a clue as to their significance. They were red leather with a three-inch stiletto heel. Although not the most expensive pair she owned, they held a special place in her wardrobe, and heart. These were her ‘fuck me’ shoes. She had several other pairs which were probably sexier—higher heels, open toes, ankle straps—but wearing these red ones made her feel sexy. Whenever Maggie wore them, she didn’t wear any panties. She wondered what Jake would say if he knew.

She moved over to the coffee machine. “Fancy a coffee?”

Jake checked his watch. “No, gotta be out of here in a few minutes. What brings you into the office so early?”

“Couldn’t sleep, and I need to catch up on a lot of paperwork. You’re in Crown Court today, right?”

He nodded. “Yeah. Sounds grand, but realistically I’m just carrying Lawrence’s briefcase and shuffling papers.”

She smiled. “I suspect you’re the eye-candy to help sway the female jurors.”

“Huh—I doubt that. I heard Lawrence tried to get you on the case, but Sam said you’d be too busy with his stuff.”

“Oh? I didn’t know that. Sounds like a lucky escape for me.”

“Yeah, maybe Sam’s just trying to avoid losing another female member of staff because of Lawrence’s *hands-on* approach.” Jake stood and dropped the papers into his briefcase. “Right, I’m off. See you later, maybe.”

“Yeah, bye.”

Maggie waved as Jake left. He was good-looking and a nice guy—so different from the pretentious twats she’d been to law school with. He was definitely boyfriend material. She’d probably end up marrying someone like him. But for some reason, his type left her a little cold. For as long as she could remember, Maggie had preferred the bad boy type.

At school she’d been drawn to the boys who were always in trouble. They had an air of danger which she couldn’t resist. At university she’d socialised with the people from her course, but her romantic liaisons were with the men she met off-campus. They were working-class and poorly-educated, although it quickly became clear that they had far more nous than she did. Being with these men gave her an undeniable buzz, a thrill she couldn’t replicate with the nice, upstanding young men her mother would like her to bring home.

Maggie placed the latte on her desk, and carried a cappuccino out to Carol. “Here you go. I was making myself one, so thought you’d like one, too.”

Carol’s pretty face showed a mixture of surprise and gratitude. “Oh, thank you so much.”

“You’re welcome.”

Back at her desk, Maggie started to go through the paperwork. It was dull and boring, but something she had to keep on top of. Perhaps that was the reason for her choice of shoes today—she needed her heart to beat a little faster so she wouldn’t fall asleep on the job.

She was surprised when she next looked at the clock—it was lunchtime. As it was a nice day outside, she decided to go for a walk. She picked up a chicken wrap at the nearby deli and walked to the benches near a small garden and fountain at one end of the wide street. Teenage boys were doing stunts on their BMX bikes, trying their best to impress the watching group of schoolgirls.

Maggie felt the warmth of the sun on her face and legs, and a pleasant breeze blowing around her uncovered sex. She wondered if any of the girls and boys would be meeting later, disappearing into the woods in the park to kiss and grope each other the way she used to. She envied them for the thrill a simple kiss could give at that age, how just a caress from the boy you fancied could send shivers all the way to your toes.

“Hiya.”

Maggie looked up to see Carol standing over her and smiled. “Oh, hi.”

“Can I join you, or are you expecting someone?”

“No, please.” Maggie moved her handbag from the seat and held up the packet which still had an untouched wrap. “Do you want one of these?”

“Thanks, but I’ve already eaten.”

Carol was relatively new to the firm, so the pair of them hadn’t spent much time together. The receptionist smiled. “I love your hair like that.”

Maggie pulled self-consciously at her shoulder-length, dark-red ringlets. She usually wore it pinned up at work. “Thanks. This is what I get when I leave home with wet hair.”

“It’s lovely, I’m so jealous. My hair’s straight and mousy-brown.”

Maggie looked at the other woman’s short blonde bob. “Your hair’s lovely.”

“It wouldn’t be if I didn’t spend a fortune getting highlights put in every month.” Carol looked over towards the group of teenagers, then back at Maggie. “Can I ask you a question?”

“Yeah, ’course you can.”

“Is there anything going on between you and Jake?”

“*What?* No, certainly not. We’re just colleagues, and mates.” She smiled. “Why, have you got your eye on him?”

“Oh, no, I, I...”

As Carol started to blush, Maggie laughed out loud. “Carol, it’s okay to fancy him. He’s a good-looking guy, and very nice. You could do a lot worse than wake up in his bed the morning after a staff party.”

Carol’s hand covered her mouth and her eyes opened wide.

Maggie laughed, putting her hand on the other girl’s arm. “Sorry, I keep forgetting I’m supposed to at least *try* and exude an air of professionalism.”

“Oh, not with me, please. I don’t want professional, I just want normal.”

Maggie smiled, wondering if Carol would consider walking around without underwear as ‘normal’ for a lady in the legal profession.

“Do you happen to know if Jake’s seeing anyone?” Carol was biting her lower lip.

“Yeah, he’s been living with a guy called Gavin for over a year.”

“He’s gay?” Carol’s voice was so loud all the teenagers turned to look their way, as did several people from the other benches.

Maggie was laughing so hard she couldn’t answer straight away. “No, I made that up. He lives alone, and I’m pretty sure he’s straight.” She smoothed down her skirt. “Sorry, I don’t know why I’m such a cruel bitch, sometimes.”

Carol was shaking her head, but also smiling broadly. “I can’t believe you did that.”

“No, sorry.”

The two women chatted amiably as they walked back to their office together. When Maggie got back to her desk she found a post-it note stuck to her computer screen. It was from Sam, asking her to call at his office when she had a minute.

She knocked once and popped her head round the door. “Hi, I’ve just seen your note.”

“Ah, come in, come in.” Sam smiled as she took the seat opposite his desk. He was in his early sixties, and had lively blue eyes under bushy brows and a shock of grey hair. “How are you, Maggie?”

“I’m fine, thank you.”

“Good, good. Well, what I wanted to talk to you about was the Alderson case.”

“Oh?” She knew it was one that troubled Sam. He’d been hired as Sean Alderson’s defence counsel after his part in a violent robbery

“Yes, yes. I’d made an appointment to visit him to try and convince him to change his plea. There’s so much evidence against him, it seems pointless trying to deny he was involved.”

“So you want him to plead guilty?” Maggie couldn’t see that happening. A security guard had been badly beaten during the break-in. “Aren’t the prosecution pushing for attempted murder?”

“I want him to accept the B and E charge, but try to claim there was no intent in the attack on the guard. We can propose Actual Bodily Harm, but advise Alderson he’ll probably get GBH because of the injuries he inflicted on the guard.”

“It might be difficult to get him to go for that,” Maggie pointed out. During the pre-trial meeting, Alderson had been convinced he’d get away with it. Several people were willing to testify he’d been at a party at the time of the crime, but all of the people providing alibis were as dishonest as he was. The prosecution had video-evidence, fingerprints and probably DNA, too, because the defendant had bitten the guard’s face during the attack.

“But the reason for me calling you in now is because I’m going to have to miss the appointment—something else has come up. I can’t get out of it, so I was wondering if you’d mind going to see Mr Alderson instead.”

Maggie sat up a little straighter in her chair. “Me?” Adrenaline started to rush through her system.

“Yes. You’ve been involved in the case, and you’ll be with me in court. You’re the logical choice to go.”

“Okay, fine. When is it?”

“Thursday afternoon.” Sam started to shuffle the papers on his desk, his usual way of letting his visitors know a meeting was over.

Maggie walked unsteadily back to her desk, her stomach in knots. Sean Alderson was a big thug of a man with a long history of petty crimes running all the way back to his early teens. She’d been in court when he was first remanded in custody and had seen his family. His wife, a mean-looking woman with dyed pink hair had shouted obscenities at the judge when he’d refused her husband bail.

Maggie had also been present when Sam had interviewed him shortly afterwards. Alderson had been unable to stop looking at her chest and legs throughout the meeting. She remembered seeing the look in his eyes, and remembered how wet her panties had been by the end of it. Maggie clenched her inner muscles and could tell she was wet again now. She picked up one of the papers on her desk and tried to get her mind back on her work.

Jake returned to the office mid-afternoon, which was earlier than usual.

Maggie watched his shoulders as he slipped off his suit jacket. She could certainly see why Carol was interested. “You’re back early.”

“Yeah, one of the witnesses had a dizzy spell.” The tone of his voice suggested he doubted the authenticity of the symptoms. “So the judge called a halt for the day.”

“Lucky you.”

Jake shrugged and emptied the contents of his briefcase into separate piles on his desk. “He’s weird, that judge. He hasn’t got any thumbs.”

Maggie looked up, puzzled. “Really? What’s his name?”

Jake smiled. “Justice Fingers.”

“Oh, god.” She shook her head as he walked over to the photocopier, chuckling to himself.

* * * *

Maggie presented herself to the prison reception on Thursday afternoon. She went through the usual procedure of presenting ID, surrendering her mobile phone to lock-up, then she was shown into the waiting room.

One of the wing officers came in to escort her to the interview rooms. His expression suggested he was surprised that Alderson's lawyer was an attractive young woman, particularly one dressed the way Maggie was.

"I'm afraid the only room that's free has a faulty CCTV camera. Would you prefer to delay by an hour to wait for one of the other rooms?"

"No, I'll be fine." Her heart beat a little faster.

"Would you like to have an officer present during the interview?" He cast his eyes down Maggie's grey fitted jacket, knee-length pencil skirt and high heels. She wasn't wearing nylons.

"No, I'm sure that won't be necessary. We'll be discussing his plea, so I think he'll be more willing to be frank if it's just the two of us." Maggie tried to give a confident smile.

"If you're sure."

The officer unlocked the security doors for the remand wing and escorted her along an otherwise empty corridor. The clicks of the heels of her red shoes on the tiled floor echoed off the walls.

When they reached WR1, the officer opened the door and stood to one side. Maggie walked into the unoccupied room and the door swung shut behind her. The walls were painted wintergreen and the lino was a dull grey. A small square metal table was bolted to the floor in the middle of the room, two hard-backed chairs facing each other on either side of it. There was another chair placed against the wall next to the door, for attending officers to use during interviews.

Maggie placed her briefcase on the floor next to one chair and glanced up at the CCTV camera mounted on a bracket high on one wall. The red light wasn't illuminated. She sat in the chair and waited, her legs shaking slightly with anticipation.

The door opened and two officers stood either side of Sean Alderson. He was wearing the prison garb of grey trousers and grey

sweatshirt. They led him into the room, and Maggie noticed one of the officers giving Alderson a warning glare before pushing him into the chair opposite her.

“We’ll be right outside.”

Maggie wasn’t sure who this comment was aimed at, since the officer was still staring at the prisoner.

“Thank you.” She tried to sound calmer than she actually felt. This was one of those occasions when she needed to exude the air of professionalism she’d told Carol about.

When the heavy door finally shut after the officers, the room seemed as quiet as if it had been sound-proofed.

She leaned down to retrieve some papers from her briefcase, and as she straightened up, she caught him blatantly looking down the top of her blouse. She waited for his eyes to move up to her face and held eye contact for a second, then looked down and sorted through the prosecution’s trial dossier. She could feel his eyes on her, smell his body odour. When she squeezed her thighs together, she felt her wetness.

“Was expectin’ the other fella.” His voice was deep, his accent strong.

She glanced up at him. His small, dark eyes looked lost in his large face. His lips were fleshy, and his teeth even but yellowed. His cheeks and nose were covered in open pores. There was a tattoo on one side of his neck, and more ink showed below the cuffs of his sweatshirt. His hands were huge. There was a hole in his left earlobe, and another two in the flesh of his forehead above his left eyebrow. Clearly quite a lot of piercing-jewellery had been removed when he was booked in.

“I’m afraid Mr Irlam had another matter he had to attend to, so I’m here instead.”

He let his eyes wander down to her chest again, then looked up into her eyes and sneered. “Fine by me.”

Maggie selected a sheet from the pile and handed it across the table. “I want you to have a read of this.”

“What is it?” He left the sheet of paper untouched, giving her the impression he wasn’t fond of reading.

She swallowed. “It’s a list of all the evidence that the prosecution has against you.”

He still didn’t pick up the page, shrugged. “Circumshall. Got witnesses said I was with them.”

“I think you mean *circumstantial*. I’m afraid alibis from your wife, brother-in-law and school friends won’t hold as much sway with the jury as the CCTV footage, which clearly shows you repeatedly kicking the security guard. In addition, your fingerprints were found on several door handles and walls within the premises. Then there’s the bite marks left in the victim’s face. The prosecution have an orthodontic expert who’s willing to testify there’s a ninety-five percent probability that your teeth were responsible. If they’ve also managed to derive a sample of your saliva, then you’d probably struggle to convince a jury that you had an alibi if you’d been having tea with the Queen.”

Maggie stood up and carried a sheaf of papers to the chair by the door. This was a deliberate move, intended to give him a chance to look at her entire body. Once seated, she looked over at him.

“Read the sheet, Sean. Consider carefully what your options are. I’ve made a list of choices open to you at the bottom of the page.” With that, she crossed her legs and pretended to read.

The room was silent. She glanced in his direction and saw he was holding the page in both hands. His face was screwed up in concentration, his lips moving silently as he read each word. She smiled to herself—this man was barely literate, yet just being alone in a room with him made her tingle all over. She squeezed her thighs together once more—the butterflies in her stomach would probably drown if they ventured south to her crotch.

He let out a sigh, scratched the side of his face and went back to the task of reading.

There were less than five hundred words on the sheet, but so far he’d been reading for almost five minutes. Maggie shifted position, this time crossing her right leg over the left. She saw his eyes flick in her direction, linger on the bare knees. She tilted her toes up, letting her right shoe dangle, her bare heel exposed. Maggie kept her gaze on the papers on

her lap, but from the corner of her eye she could see his head turning slightly every few seconds. He couldn't resist ogling her legs.

Still pretending to read, she bent forward and took off her shoe. She spread and wiggled her elegant toes, the nails expertly painted a deep red. She knew Sean was looking at her feet. Maggie had seen his wife's feet—large slabs of white meat with toes as thick as a man's thumb. Stepping back into her shoe, she stood and dropped her papers onto the chair. He was staring at her body, so she waited until he looked up into her face.

“What do you think?”

He seemed confused, and she half-expected him to make some crude comment about her body. Instead, he shook his head slowly and shrugged.

“Can I speak frankly, Sean?”

He shrugged again.

Maggie decided to move onto the next stage. She slipped her jacket off her shoulders and placed it across the seat of the chair she'd just been sitting on. She saw his eyes taking in the sheerness of her blouse, the clearly-visible lace bra, the smallness of her waist, the swell of her hips in the tight-fitting skirt.

He licked his lips.

She felt the wetness between her legs. “Sean?”

“Uh?” He looked up from her body.

“With all the evidence against you, I have to advise that it would be in your best interests to reconsider your plea.”

“What?”

“As your lawyers, it is our duty to try and get as light a sentence as we can.”

He shook his head. “Witnesses. Alibi.”

Maggie sighed. “Sean, they won't help. Of the seven people who claimed you were with them, five have criminal records. One of them was actually booked for speeding on the same night, over forty miles away. Their stories won't hold up to cross-examination, I'm afraid.”

His eyes narrowed as his brain struggled to process this latest information.

“We think you should accept the Breaking and Entering charge, and try to plea-bargain the attempted-murder for a lesser assault charge.”

“I never meant to hurt him.” As soon as the words were out, he slapped his hand to his mouth. This was the first time he’d admitted his guilt to counsel.

“I’m sure you didn’t, but we need to convince the jury of that in court.”

When she took a step closer, he lowered his gaze to look at her legs. She was slightly breathless and her heartbeat drummed against her ribs.

“I think we should try and convince the jury you panicked and lashed out at the security guard in an attempt to escape. But there’s no escaping the fact you inflicted severe injuries on the man.”

Sean kept his eyes on her red shoes. He nodded slowly, accepting he would probably be prosecuted after all. “How long?”

Maggie walked around the table, letting him have a good look at her backside. She used her pen to scratch the back of her head, knowing the deep auburn chignon allowed him a clear view of her slender neck. “I’m afraid with your history, the judge won’t be inclined to show leniency.”

Confusion creased his face. “What’s that mean?”

“It means he’s going to send you away for a long time.”

“How long?”

She stopped moving and stood two feet from his chair. “I can’t answer that.”

“A year? Two?”

“Sean, you’ve got a track record as long as your arm, and you put a security guard in hospital because he tried to do his job. The prosecution are saying you tried to kill him.”

“I never. He swung first—with his torch.”

Maggie could sense his exasperation. “Sean, you’ll be going away for a lot longer than two years.”

She was standing on the ledge, ready to take the leap.

His small eyes stared at the floor.

Her hands shook. "I think it's safe to say this will probably be the last time you're alone with a woman for a long time."

He looked up from the paper in his hand, his eyes lingering on her body before staring into her eyes. His jaw was clenched tight.

Maggie's throat constricted and she wasn't sure if she'd be able to get the words out. "Maybe you should make the most of it." She was so close to living out a fantasy she'd had since first entering law school.

He frowned, looked hungrily at her body once more. "Don't you think I'm in enough trouble already?"

Maggie started to slowly pull her skirt up, revealing more of her bare legs, inch by inch.

He stared at her thighs as the skirt was pulled higher. He licked his lips again. "They'd throw away the key."

"Not if they don't find out..."

When she bunched the skirt around her waist, he saw she wasn't wearing any underwear. Shock registered on his face, but then he dropped the sheet of paper and leaned forward.

She felt his rough hands gripping her hips and a gasp escaped her lips as he pulled her towards him.

He forced a hand between her legs and she saw him smirk when he discovered how wet she was. Standing up, he easily lifted her off the floor and sat her on the metal table. She parted her legs and he rammed two fingers into her sex.

She tried to stifle her squeal of pleasure.

"You dirty little..." He finger-fucked her hard and she came immediately, unable to contain the whimpers as she tightened around his thick fingers.

He put his face close to hers, his bad breath invading her nostrils. "You're gagging for this, you dirty little slag."

She stared at him through half-closed eyes, inhaling sharply through clenched teeth. She nodded. "Fuck me."

His left hand fumbled with his trousers while he continued to pleasure her with his right. As his trousers slid down his thighs, he removed his fingers, gripped her hips in both hands and dragged her to the edge of the table. Her bare backside squeaked across the metal table-top.

He sneered as he positioned his cock at her entrance, then bared his teeth as he slammed into her, pulling her hips toward him.

She yelped. He was a lot bigger than she'd been expecting, his initial thrust painful. He slammed into her again and the groan caught in her throat. He brought one hand up to roughly grope her breast through her blouse and bra, then gripped her hips again.

Maggie pushed herself forward to meet his next thrust. One of her shoes fell off and landed on the floor as she wrapped her legs around his thighs. He fucked her hard and she came a second time. She leaned forward and bit into his shoulder.

“Argh, yer fucking bitch.”

He banged her even harder, which was exactly what she'd wanted. She clung on to his arms as he continued his assault. Her eyes started to water from the pain.

Suddenly he stepped back and out of her. He pulled her roughly to her feet and turned her round, bending her over the table. She had to stand on tiptoe with one foot to compensate for the lack of shoe.

She felt his hand run over the soft curve of her arse, heard his grunt of approval. Then his cock slid into her again and she gripped the edges of the table as he proceeded to fuck her with more force than she'd ever experienced. She was certain the table would have fallen over if it hadn't been bolted to the floor.

She looked up and gasped. The red light on the CCTV camera was blinking.

Blinking. Shit.

Wait – did that mean it was working, or it wasn't?

She tried to remember what the light usually did, but it was hard to concentrate while she was being fucked so hard. *Were they actually being filmed?* It was too late to worry about that now.

His hands slid up inside the front of her blouse and pushed her bra upwards, releasing her boobs. He squeezed them painfully in his hands and pulled her nipples while continuing to fuck her. It went on for minutes and Maggie knew she'd be able to come again. She started clenching her muscles in time with his thrusts.

Sean evidently noticed. "Oh yeah, you dirty bitch."

She pushed back, clenched harder as if trying to force him out of her,

"Oh, it's syrup time."

The cheesy cliché would usually turn her off or make her laugh out loud, but it just spurred her on. She started to roll her hips, eager for him to come.

"Oh, here we go, here we go, here we fucking..."

He held still for a second and she felt his cock pulse inside her. She knew he was coming, a torrent flooding into her.

He pushed into her again—a single, violent thrust. "Go!"

The surging wave of Maggie's third orgasm finally broke. It was as if her stomach melted and lungs imploded at the same time. She could see multi-coloured flashes of light hovering in her peripheral vision, and her legs started to shake.

His hands were back on her hips, fingers digging painfully into the soft flesh just below her waist. She could hear his ragged breathing and wondered how she'd explain the situation if he had a heart attack.

He stepped back and she stood upright. There was an awkwardness, and she kept her back to him while she adjusted her clothes. She pulled her bra over her boobs, straightened her blouse and pushed her skirt back down over her hips and legs, smoothing it down with her hands. Then she bent and put her shoe back on. When she turned round to face him, his trousers were fastened. His expression was one of shock, not the smug satisfaction she'd expected.

Maggie picked up his discarded piece of paper and walked back to her side of the table. She sat down, noticed the table-top was smeared with her own juices and wiped her hand across the surface.

Handing the sheet of paper back to Sean, she saw his face was bathed in sweat.

He looked down at the words briefly, then back at her. “So, what now?”

She picked up her briefcase and stood. “You’re going to admit to breaking into the premises with the intention of stealing. You’re going to admit having an altercation with the security guard, but we’re going to suggest his injuries were a result of you trying to get away.”

Sean lowered his head, nodded once.

Maggie returned the sheaf of papers to her briefcase, then slipped her jacket back on.

“Will you visit me again, before the trial?”

She turned to look at him, knew what he was really asking. “No, Sean, I won’t. This was a one-time opportunity—for both of us.”

Sean gave a shrug of resignation.

Walking to the door, she knocked once and it was opened from outside. She couldn’t stop thinking about the blinking light on the camera.

One of the officers smiled as he looked into her face. “Everything alright?”

She nodded, trying to hold her nerve. “Fine.”

He looked over her shoulder into the room, smiled when he saw Sean sitting at the desk. “Not so hard now, is he?”

Her heart skipped a beat. *What did he mean by that?*

As she was escorted back down the corridor, Maggie tried to convince herself he’d been referring to the change in Alderson’s attitude, rather than the state of his cock, but it was hard to stay calm with the evidence of their tryst seeping out of her and onto her inner thighs. Once through the main security door, she looked at the officer. “Is there a loo I could use before I drive back to the office?”

He nodded, led her to a small side-corridor. “Through there, second door on the left.”

“Thanks.”

Once inside, she used tissues to wipe the mess from her thighs, then mopped up as much of the remaining cum still inside her as she could. As she washed her hands, she looked at herself in the mirror. Her cheeks were a little flushed, but other than that, there was nothing to suggest she'd just lived out her sexual fantasy. Now that the heat of their encounter had passed, she couldn't stop thinking about the blinking light on the camera, or the smirk on the officer's face.

* * * *

When she got back to the office, she found Jake and Carol chatting in the reception area. Maggie gave Carol a secret smile as she made her way to her desk. She went to Sam's office and left a note on his desk confirming Alderson was prepared to change his plea.

Back in the main office, Jake wandered through from reception, made his way to his desk and smiled at her. "How'd it go at the prison—did you get what you wanted?"

She looked up, startled, then realised what he'd meant. She squeezed her legs together—she was still a little tender. "Fine. Mission accomplished. How was court?"

Jake shook his head and shrugged. "Another adjournment."

"Oh dear." She smiled, tilted her head to one side. "You and Carol seemed to be having a nice chat..."

Jake blushed. "We were just talking."

"Hmm. She's very pretty, don't you think?"

He raised his eyebrows as if this was the first time he'd thought about it. "Yeah, I suppose so..."

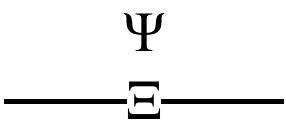
"You should ask her out to dinner."

Jake looked uncomfortable. "I'm not sure if that's a good idea. It's probably not the sort of thing you should do, dating someone you work with."

"Jake, you can't spend your life doing what you *should* do, you have to do what you *want* to do."

Maggie squeezed her legs together again, reminding herself she'd done exactly that.





The Bigger Picture

Max sat in bed playing *Assassin's Creed Syndicate* on his Xbox. He glanced over at the alarm clock—it was a little before eleven. Tony had said he'd be back from work shortly after midday, so Max decided this would be his last game.

With both parents at work, he was alone in the house. He considered masturbating again, but instead got up and took a shower. Once dressed, he went downstairs and put some cereal into a bowl and added milk. He ate at the kitchen table, using his phone to check his Facebook page.

Although there were numerous 'virtual friends' he'd met through IGN and other gaming websites, he had pitifully few friends in real life. At school he'd been something of a loner. It hadn't been a conscious decision on his part—it had more to do with his awkward demeanour. His lack of talent in any kind of sport had limited his friendships with other boys, and his gangly frame and acne-ridden skin had restricted his chances of having any girlfriends. He'd be going to university at the end of the summer, and Tony was probably the only one who'd visit him there.

By the time Max had finished breakfast it was almost midday, so he set off for the ten-minute walk to Tony's. Keeping his gaze fixed on the ground, he walked down the relatively empty pavements of their council estate. He'd left school after sitting his final exam, but the younger children still had another few weeks of term before their holidays started. He called at Mani's newsagent and picked up a gaming magazine, and a few minutes later he reached Tony's house. He pressed the doorbell, but nobody answered. He knocked on the door, in case the bell wasn't working. He knocked again, then browsed the cover of his magazine to see what free downloads were included.

"There's nobody home, love."

Max looked up, startled, and blinked a few times. The next-door neighbour stood at the fence. She was a large woman of about forty.

“Tony’s expecting me.”

She looked up and down the road. “His car’s not here. I think he’s at work.”

Checking his watch, Max tried to remember if Tony had said this was the time he’d be home, or the time he’d finish his shift. He knew the warehouse was a thirty-minute drive away. He shrugged. “Yeah, maybe he got held up.”

She smiled at him. “D’you want a brew while you wait?”

Tony had told him several stories about his neighbour’s exploits. Apparently all four of her children had different fathers.

“Er...” Max blinked again, a nervous habit he’d developed many years earlier. It took the form of two or three rapid blinks, followed by his eyes opening very wide.

“Come on, I could use your help with our Jacqui’s wardrobe, too.”

“What?”

When he saw the woman was already heading up the driveway towards her back door, Max followed. He watched her legs wobble inside her black leggings as she stepped inside.

The back door opened into the kitchen, and the lady was filling the kettle as Max followed her in. The table was covered with several half-empty cereal bowls, and the sink was full of pots and pans.

“I’m Sheila, by the way.” She smiled, and Max thought her face was pretty, even if her chin seemed to disappear into her neck.

“M... Max.” He nodded and smiled back, trying to control his blinking.

“I’ve seen you before, with Tony.” She placed two mugs on the counter and opened a cupboard. “Tea or coffee?”

“Coffee, thanks.”

“Sugar?”

“Not for me, no.” His doctor had advised him to cut out sugar and sweets to help his skin condition.

When the drinks were poured Sheila picked them up. “Let’s go through to the living room so I don’t have to look at all the washing up I

need to do.”

She must have seen Max’s hesitancy. “Come on, I don’t bite.” She giggled childishly, then added, “Well—not much, anyway.”

He blinked and followed her through a small hallway, littered with children’s shoes, into the living room which faced the road. There was still no sign of Tony’s car.

Sheila held both mugs and told him to sit down. Both armchairs had toys thrown on them, so he sat on the settee. She passed him his drink, then sat next to him.

He smiled, blinked, and took a sip of his coffee. It was foul, and too hot to drink.

“So, how d’you know Tony? From work?”

“No, school.”

“Old friends, eh?” She smiled, took a sip of her coffee.

Tony had left school two years earlier, but Max had stayed on to take his A-levels. “We play on-line video games together.”

Max returned her smile, nodded and blinked. He noticed her huge breasts pressing against the thin cotton of her t-shirt. Her stomach made a similar bulge in the material a little lower down. He realised she’d seen him looking at her breasts and looked away, blinked and sipped his coffee.

“So, what else do you and Tony talk about?”

Although he knew she was just being friendly, part of him worried she’d overheard their conversations about her numerous men-friends. Every time a different man walked up her drive, Tony would say ‘He’ll be the next to nail the whale.’

Max shrugged. “Oh, you know. Just stuff.”

She nodded, a knowing look on her face. “Yeah, I can imagine. I know what boys are like—you’re probably comparing all the girls you’ve both been with.”

“Oh no, no.” Max shook his head shyly, looked down at his feet.

Sheila pushed her large, meaty thigh against his thin, bony one. “I bet you two have lots of stories to share.”

Max shrugged and shook his head again. He'd never actually kissed a girl on the mouth. Every time he'd try to get a kiss at the youth club disco, the girl would turn her head at the last second, so he'd always end up sort of sucking her cheek.

"How old are you, Max?"

"Eight... Eighteen."

"Eighteen? Oh god, I wish I was eighteen again."

He smiled, blinked and nodded.

"Where do you work, Max?"

"Nowhere. I've just left school." Max smiled, proud of himself.

"Got accepted to university."

"Oh, a smart one, eh? Good for you."

"Thanks." He didn't see the need to explain his teachers had advised he only applied to the universities who accepted students with low grades in their A-levels, so he just smiled some more and tried to minimise his blinking.

She moved a little closer. "There'll be lots of girls at university, I suppose."

He could feel the pressure of her leg against his getting stronger. She was leaning against him.

"Yeah, I suppose." He took a gulp of coffee.

"I bet you'll have your pick of them, good-looking young lad like you."

Max looked away, embarrassed. He knew he wasn't good-looking, and he wondered why she'd say such a thing.

"I remember when I was your age, the boys only had one thing on their minds—'cos of all those hormones. And they could keep going at it all night long."

"Oh." Max knew she was looking at him, but he kept his eyes fixed on the floor.

"I bet you can keep going all night, too. You'll show them girls at that university, eh?"

He was beginning to feel a little uncomfortable with the way the conversation was going, and remembered what she'd said earlier. "You mentioned you needed help with a wardrobe..."

She pushed her huge arm into his ribs. "Ooh, there's you, trying to get me upstairs!"

Max almost spat the coffee from his mouth. "No, I was just... It's that Tony'll be here soon, and if you needed help..."

She struggled to get off the couch, pushing down on the seat with a hand to get herself up onto her feet. "Come on then—take me upstairs, you smooth talker."

A hesitant laugh got caught in his throat, and Max followed her through the maze of shoes and up the stairs.

She led him to the small back bedroom which had pink walls and One Direction posters on the wall over the bed. There was a half-assembled flat-pack wardrobe in the middle of the floor, and in the corner of the room was a bundle of clothes piled onto a dining chair. The bed was unmade and the carpet was littered with discarded clothes.

Sheila looked round the room shaking her head. "Our Jacqui's a messy bitch."

Max walked over to the wardrobe and picked up the instructions. After scanning them, he looked round for the bag of fittings and spotted them on the windowsill, next to a screwdriver. He started assembling the piece of furniture. In less than ten minutes the wardrobe was built, and together they moved it into the corner where the chair of clothes had been.

He looked at the pile of clothes. "Do you want to put them inside now?"

"No, she can do that herself. Come on, there's something I want to show you."

Without really thinking about what she might want to show him, Max followed her along the landing and into the main bedroom at the front. Sheila's bedroom.

She turned when she reached the bed, looking at him with a smile.

Max stopped in his tracks just inside the door. He blinked. His throat was tight, but there was a strange excitement to his overall feeling of

unease.

“I bet you haven’t been with anyone old enough to be your mum before, have you?”

He opened his mouth to answer, but any words he might have thought of were lost somewhere between his brain and his lips. He just stared back at her, unsure of what to do, or even what he *wanted* to do.

“But you have been with someone, haven’t you? You know—girls your own age.”

Another open-mouthed stare was all he could manage. She took a step toward him and he considered making a run for it. But something kept him there, a kind of morbid curiosity.

A smile spread between her round cheeks. “Oh, Max. You must be climbing the walls—all those hormones.” She walked slowly towards him.

His mouth dried up and he tried to hide the fact he was shaking,

She stood close, pushed her breasts against him. “All revved up and nowhere to go.”

He swallowed, tried to smile but failed. He blinked a couple of times, enjoying the softness of her breasts.

Her hand grazed across the crotch of his jeans and he yelped. She laughed, a full chuckle which set up a tremor that ran through her neck and boobs. “Oh, Max, you really need somewhere to go.”

Max looked through the window to see if Tony’s car was there, but then it clicked—she was still talking about being all revved up with nowhere to go. She was telling him he needed somewhere to shoot his load.

Her hands came up and she pulled her t-shirt over her head in one smooth movement. She dropped it onto the floor and stared into his eyes.

Max held his breath, stood stock-still. He kept his eyes on hers for as long as he could, but then lowered his gaze to the large mounds of white flesh spilling out of the black bra.

She wiggled her shoulders, sending another ripple through her fleshy chest and arms. “Like what you see, Max?”

He didn’t, but nodded anyway.

“Have you ever felt a pair of tits before?”

Max bit his lip and blinked. He slowly shook his head.

She took his hand and placed it on the upper part of her breast, above where the bra cup dug into the flesh.

Max's legs shook slightly. Her skin was softer than he'd imagined.

"Want to see my nipples?"

He wasn't sure if he did, but found himself nodding again anyway.

The excess flesh of her upper arms bulged out as she reached behind to release her bra. When the black garment fell away, Max looked at her nipples. They were pale pink and flattened, the areolae much bigger than those of the girls on the websites he watched while masturbating.

She placed her hands beneath her breasts and lifted them up, pushing them together slightly so they formed one huge white mass. "Suck my nipples, Max."

Her voice was husky, and he found it exciting. She was whispering the sort of things he dreamed about being said to him—he'd just never dreamed about hearing them from someone like Sheila.

She pointed one of her nipples toward his face, and Max bent and opened his mouth. As he closed his lips around her soft skin, she let out a breath which was warm on his neck, making him shiver. The nipple began to swell in his mouth, spurring him to suck harder.

She moaned and pulled his head further onto her bust. Her ample breast crushed against his face, covering his nose and smothering him. Sheila pulled him tighter, her fingers gripping his hair.

Max tried to pull his head away, but she was gripping him too tightly. In a panic, he used his fingers to squash the part of her tit that was covering his upper face, taking in a deep breath through his nose.

Sheila stepped back and sat on the end of the bed. "Ooh, you're getting me all revved up, now." She started to roll her leggings over her plentiful hips and down her thighs.

Max noticed the nipple he'd been sucking was puckered and harder than the other, and he felt strangely proud of himself. It was still wet with his saliva.

I've actually sucked a tit.

Sheila kicked her leggings off her feet and only when he saw her panties inside them did Max realise she'd taken them off—her belly hung so low into her lap that he couldn't see her sex.

“Come closer, Max.”

Her voice was the husky whisper again, and he liked it. He really liked her face—she must have been pretty when she was younger. Thinner. She had nice eyes, an unusually pale shade of blue.

He took a step closer, looked down at her large thighs—mottled with cellulite and flattened on the bed. There were numerous broken thread-veins, like faded-blue tattoos of Arabic writing.

She reached out with her hand and stroked the crotch of his jeans.

He jumped, but managed to avoid yelping this time.

Her hand gripped his cock, which was getting harder by the second. She smiled up at him. “Hmm, all revved up.”

He was relieved he'd got a hard-on. He'd jacked off only a couple of hours earlier, and had done it twice last night. He held his breath as Sheila started to undo his belt. Next were the buttons, and as she pushed his jeans and briefs down his thighs, his fully-erect cock sprung out.

She wrapped a big plump hand around it, leaned forward and ran her tongue over the already-slick bulbous tip. She smiled up at his face. “Seeing as this is your first time, it'll be better to just get inside and let it happen.”

Max blinked, then nodded.

“Take your clothes off, Max.”

He quickly stripped, watching as she pushed herself further up onto the bed. He stood motionless as she positioned herself, the flesh of her thighs and hips pooling a little on the sheet. When she parted her legs, he couldn't take his eyes off her sex.

The fleshy parts of her outer lips were darker than he'd expected, not as pink as the models on the internet. They were slick with a covering of her juices.

“Come on, Max.”

He placed a knee on the bed. Looked up into her face. When she smiled and batted her eyes, he was glad she was pretty. *I'm going to have*

sex. He placed his hand on the bed beside her stomach, felt her hands on his waist, pulling him further up the bed. *I'm going to nail the whale.*

Sheila put her hand down between their bodies, gripped his cock and guided him into position.

He held his breath. Hoped he didn't come before he'd actually had sex. Looked apprehensively into her face.

She smiled, placed a podgy hand on each of his skinny buttocks and pulled him into her.

He let out a whimper and was instantly embarrassed by it. He was shocked at the experience. He lay cocooned in her body, every part of him snug in warm softness. Her boobs crushed against his chest, her big arms covered his sides as she stroked over the spots on his back. His hips and upper legs were enclosed in the soft flesh of her thighs. But the most intense, fantastic sensation was that on his cock, enveloped in the warm wet softness of her sex. Her big, juicy cunt. *I'm having sex. I'm actually fucking somebody.*

She held him close, started to move beneath him, undulating in a slow rhythm.

Max closed his eyes. He was a child again, relaxing at the seaside, his inflatable mattress tilting on the gently-rolling waves. His balls tingled.

She hummed in his ear, comforting him. "Shush, it's okay."

Max hadn't realised he'd been whimpering. His body was in heaven and he didn't want it to be over so soon, but Sheila must have known exactly what he was going through.

"Come on, baby, let it go. Just enjoy the ride and let it all out, don't try and hold back."

Max pulled his head back and stared into her face. She *was* pretty. His body was completely still, rigid.

She carried on moving her hips, smiled reassuringly at him. "Come in me, Max. Let it all go."

He cried out as he exploded, his neck muscles straining against his skin. The only thing he could compare it to was the relief he got after delaying a piss for too long. The sudden release was overwhelming, almost

painful, but then the euphoria of relaxing and emptying took over, making his legs shake.

Sheila was still rocking below him, and more spunk gushed from his hard, throbbing cock into her soft hot hole. It was all so much better than he'd ever imagined.

She kissed his eyes and he stopped blinking, felt his body relax, wither.

Sheila stopped her movements and stroked his arms and shoulders. "There, not so revved up now, are we?"

He smiled and shook his head. "No, not anymore."

She cradled his head and they lay in silence. They heard Tony's car pull up outside, but neither mentioned it.

They lay together for fifteen minutes, and then Sheila eased him off her and onto his back.

She knelt up on the bed, leaning over him.

He thought her enormous tits looked like space-hoppers, hanging down onto the mattress. He wanted to stroke them, suck the nipples again.

She blew into his ear. "I know what boys of eighteen can do. I'm going to get you hard, and we're going to go again."

Goose-bumps broke out down his back. He looked up into her smiling eyes, wondering whether to tell her how many times he'd jacked off in the last twelve hours. "Okay."

Sheila shuffled round a little to face his hips, her tits swinging freely as she positioned her head over his groin.

Holding his breath, he watched as she took his limp cock in her hand and lowered her head, opening her mouth. He let out a breathy sigh as he felt her mouth on him, her tongue. He couldn't believe how good it felt. When she squeezed the base with her hand and bobbed her head up and down, his blood started pumping and the hardness returned to his cock.

Sheila looked back at him triumphantly, the bulbous tip of his cock peeking out proudly from her chubby fist.

A thin strand of clear goo stretched from the end of his cock to her lips. Max wasn't sure if it was his cum or her saliva, but he knew the image

of her smiling with the strand draped to his cock in her hand would stick with him for a long time.

She shuffled back so her knees were nudging his ribs and leaned down to look into his eyes. "This time I'm going to make it extra special."

He stared into her clear blue eyes, wondering what could surpass the sensations he'd just experienced.

Leaning toward her bedside drawers, she searched for a few seconds then sat back up. In her hands were a vibrator and a condom.

Max stared wide-eyed, his pulse making his cock twitch in time with his heartbeat.

After ripping open the wrapper, she rolled the condom down the vibrator. "This is going to get us both off in a way you won't believe."

Max watched as she smoothed the rubber down onto the pink plastic with a finger and thumb. Then she took a tube of clear jelly and started to smear it over the tip of the rubber-sheathed toy. He hadn't a clue what was going to happen, but he couldn't remember being this excited before.

Sheila straddled him, held his cock vertical and lowered herself onto it.

She was even wetter than before, and Max delighted in the knowledge it was his spunk inside her. She gyrated her hips and he arched his back, revelling in the sensation of being inside her again. She leaned forward, her breasts crushing against his chest. She held the vibrator in her right hand and moved her arm behind her.

He was aware of her hand brushing against his balls as she manoeuvred the toy. He saw her eyes narrow slightly, then her lips pulled back and her nostrils flared. He felt something move against his cock, through the thin wall of tissue. She'd inserted the vibrator up her backside. He saw her start to move her arm, and felt the simultaneous movement of the toy against his cock.

Sheila let out a long sigh, then began to grunt in time with each push of her hand. Her eyes were closed, teeth clenched.

Max felt his cock being squeezed and Sheila let out a high-pitched squeal, then pounded the toy into her while bucking her hips. He knew she was coming, and wanted to make things nice for her, but wasn't sure what

he should do. He pushed his hips up and she moaned. Encouraged, he kept thrusting into her while she kept fucking herself up the arse with her toy.

Her moans got louder. “Yeah, fuck me, fuck me, fuck me.”

He tried, but she was too heavy. He wanted to thrust so hard that he lifted her off the bed, but that was never going to happen. He felt her contract again. He hadn’t expected to be able to feel her coming—he’d read about women being able to fake it.

She opened her eyes and smiled at him. “Are you ready for this?”

He frowned, unsure how to answer. Unsure of what she meant.

The toy hummed and he felt it vibrating against his cock. His eyes opened wide in shock and Sheila moved on him with short, fast bucks of her hips.

His toes spread and his legs locked straight. The sensation of the toy on his cock was so intense he pushed his head back into the pillows and grunted as he came again inside her.

Sheila sat up and bounced on him. He felt the protruding base of the sex-toy hitting against his balls as she rode him, but he didn’t care. He grabbed hold of her breasts, his fingers covered by the bulging soft flesh as he squeezed her tits. Her guttural moans turned to screams as she came a third time.

Max understood why she was so popular with all the men. He looked at her pink cheeks, strands of her hair clinging to her sweating face and neck. He felt himself softening inside her, and she finally slowed her movements.

She opened her eyes, smiled at him. “Wasn’t that more fun than playing video games?”

He grinned and nodded. His mobile buzzed from the pocket of his jeans on the floor.

Glancing over at the pile of clothes, she nudged his ribs with her elbow. “That’ll probably be Tony.”

He shrugged, showing he had no intention of answering it.

A smile crossed her pretty face. “Come on, let’s have another brew.”

She pulled on her leggings and wrapped a dressing gown around her.

Max got dressed and followed her downstairs. He returned to the living room while she went into the kitchen. On the wall were two framed photographs. One showed all four kids at some kind of party. The eldest girl was very pretty, big blue eyes like her mother. Max thought none of the kids really looked like each other, but reasoned it wasn't too surprising if they all had different fathers. There was another picture of the older girl on her own in a short party dress. She had great legs and an hourglass figure.

Sheila returned with two mugs and a box of biscuits balanced on a tray. She put the tray down and came to stand next to him. She nodded at the family group photo. "That's my brood." She pointed to each face in turn. "Kirsty, Lucy, Michael and Jacqui."

Max nodded, not wanting to admit he fancied her daughter. He pointed to the other picture. "Kirsty, right?"

Sheila laughed. "No, that's me at my eighteenth birthday party. I was very like her at that age—I hope she doesn't end up like me."

Max turned, a bit surprised. "I think you ended up okay."

Her eyes sparkled, and she squeezed his arm. "Come and drink your coffee."

They sat on the settee and she picked up his mug, handed it to him. "So, which university will you be going to?"

He blinked. "I'm not sure yet. Maybe Leicester or Middlesbrough. Leeds, if I manage to get the grades."

She nodded. "I never got the chance to go to university. Too daft, me. Left school at sixteen and started work in a hairdresser's. Two years later I got pregnant with our Kirsty, and that was that."

Max let this information trickle through him. Sheila had a daughter who was several years older than he was.

Blowing on her drink, she looked at him over the rim of her cup. "So, you'll know what to do with all those girls at university, now."

She pushed her leg against his, and he pushed back, enjoying the warmth of their contact. "Yeah." He hoped he could find a girl at university as big and soft as Sheila.

He saw Tony walking down his garden path and getting into his car.

Sheila saw him, too. “He’s probably going to drive over to your house, see where you are.”

Max shrugged. “I’m not in.”

“Will you tell him where you’ve been, what you’ve done?”

He flinched at the thought of Tony saying ‘*You’ve nailed the whale?*’ and shook his head. “No, this has nothing to do with him.”

She looked into his eyes. “Do you think you’d like to call here again, before you disappear off to Leicester or wherever?”

Surprised, he looked up. The idea appealed to him—a lot. “Yeah, I’d like that.”

Sheila smiled, showing dimples in her cheeks. She leaned forwards and kissed him on the mouth.

Max knew this was actually their first kiss, which seemed strange considering what they’d done upstairs. When her tongue pushed into his mouth, he let out a groan.

She pulled back, took the mug from his hand and placed both cups back on the tray on the floor. She leaned over, kissed him again.

When her hand stroked his crotch he moaned out loud, but he felt his cock beginning to swell once more.

Sheila smiled. “Eighteen-year-olds.” She undid his belt and buttons and freed his cock. “Stand up.”

He did as instructed, and she positioned him directly in front of her. She sat on the edge of the cushion and gripped his cock. She looked up into his face. “Don’t hold back, just enjoy it and let whatever happens happen. Okay?”

Max looked down at her, nodded once. Then he was inside her mouth and his eyes closed. He felt her mouth, her tongue, her hands—one wanking him, the other squeezing his balls. *I’m getting a blow job.*

She wanked him faster, squeezed him harder, tongued him more.

He understood what she’d told him, so didn’t bother warning her. He just shot his load into her mouth and listened to her moan and swallow.

She squeezed his balls and he fired again. She swallowed and continued to lick and suck him until he softened.

Then she released him and smiled up at his face. “How was that?”

He couldn’t answer, but she laughed when she saw his expression.

“That’s what I thought.” She eased his cock back inside his briefs and stood up. “Right, I need to get some clothes on and get to the school gates for our Jacqui.”

He fastened his jeans and belt.

She passed him a note pad. “Write your mobile number on there, maybe I can text you one day next week.”

Nodding enthusiastically, he jotted down his number.

A couple of minutes later he was walking along the road towards home when Tony’s car pulled up at the kerb.

His friend leaned over and opened the passenger door. “Where’ve you been?”

Max bent and stuck his head through the open door. “You weren’t in, so I walked into town.” He held up his magazine.

Tony nodded. “Wanna come back now, fire up the Xbox?”

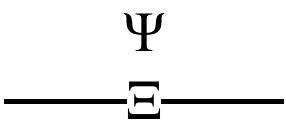
Max shook his head. “No, just going to amble back home and have a kip. I’m knackered.”

Tony tutted. “Lazy bastard. Typical student—you should try working for a living.”

“There’s more to life than work and computer games. You’ve got to see the bigger picture.”

As Tony pulled away, Max gave him the finger, a broad smile on his face.





Wedding Belles

The speeches were over, and all the guests sat at their tables, drinking and chatting. Joanna and Gareth were at a table with some of their oldest friends. They'd all met at high school and had grown up together. All had attended each other's weddings around twelve years ago, and though a few from their crowd had either separated or divorced, today's wedding was the first time that one of them had re-married.

Tony, the groom, walked towards to their table with a big smile. Joanna had always been fond of him, and they'd actually had a brief 'thing' for a few weeks when they were about fifteen.

He made his way round the table, each guest standing in turn to give him a hug.

"Thanks for being here today, you guys."

Gareth gave a snort. "When do we ever turn down free food and drink?"

Tony smiled. "Yeah, well, it means a lot."

Everyone complimented him on the wedding.

"It was a lovely service..."

"The meal was fabulous..."

"This is a great hotel..."

Their friend Danny was his usual blunt self. "Your missus looks fit. I don't know how you managed to pull somebody like that."

Tony laughed. "Cheers, mate."

The banter continued for a few minutes, and an older man in a dark grey suit approached the groom and whispered something in his ear.

Tony replied in a hushed tone and looked round at his friends. "Looks like you guys have been drinking too much, as usual. We've used up the allocated number of bottles of wine, so I've ordered another twenty

bottles. Get your order in now, because when that's gone, you'll need to put your hands in your own pockets and go to the bar."

Gareth looked at the man in the suit. "Four bottles of red and two white."

The man smiled in a way that made Joanna think he dealt with people like Gareth frequently. "I'm afraid I can only bring one of each for now, sir." He spoke with an accent Joanna couldn't place—maybe eastern European—then walked over to give instructions to one of the waiters tending the tables.

Gareth frowned at Tony. "You cheapskate, Parkins."

"Bollocks. I've supplied twenty bottles of champagne, and now I've also provided sixty bottles of wine. You haven't even bought yourself a new tie."

The others at the table all giggled.

Tony bent so his mouth was next to Gareth's ear, but spoke loud enough for everyone at the table to hear. "Don't forget, you're only here because we like your wife." He tapped Gareth's shoulder before walking over to chat with the guests at an adjacent table.

Gareth looked down and readjusted his tie. "Cheeky twat."

Joanna put her hand on his arm, but couldn't help smiling. "It serves you right for being greedy and trying to get all the extra wine."

The new wine arrived, glasses were refilled and the pleasant conversation continued. The friends caught up with each other's news, discussing their recent holidays, kids, jobs and homes.

Helena looked over at Joanna. "You look fabulous, you bitch."

Geraldine joined in with the flattery. "Yeah, I'm not standing next to you in any of the photos."

Joanna smiled, embarrassed by her friends' comments, but very grateful. It'd been a long struggle after having two children in the space of three years, but now that Ethan had started school and Ollie was in pre-school, she finally had the time and energy to get her life back in order. After finding a part time job in an estate agent's she'd worked hard to get her figure back. Her body was the reward after weeks of sweaty running and hours in the gym.

Joanna saw Helena check her phone, and smiled. She'd been checking her own for messages every half hour. "Where are your two?"

"My mum's. This'll be the first time I've left them anywhere overnight."

"Same here. The boys are at my sister's, so they'll be playing with their cousins. They'll probably be grouchy and over-tired when we get them back tomorrow."

A smile crossed Helena's face and she leaned closer to Joanna. "I'm hoping to be over-tired myself. We've got a four-poster bed in our room, which I intend making the most of."

Geraldine overheard and nodded towards the men. "They're all talking about football—you can make Nigel score at both ends."

Joanna almost spat her wine out.

Helena laughed and nodded towards Joanna. "I love that dress, Jo."

"Thank you." The pale blue silk dress was full-length with a slit up the front which revealed a flash of leg up to her thigh. It was sleeveless and had a fitted waist, emphasising her toned arms and athletic figure.

Amanda joined the conversation. "Me and Danny have spent two weeks in Portugal, but neither of us have got a tan as good as yours."

Joanna smiled and straightened her right leg out at the side of the table, exposing the perfect bronzed limb. A stiletto-heeled white sandal adorned her tanned foot, the toenails painted dark blue. "Three days in Abersoch during half-term."

Everyone at the table seemed to stop their conversation and look down at Joanna's leg.

Gareth took a sip of his wine and nodded towards his wife. "She'll be getting it later."

The men laughed and the women shook their heads in dismay. It was as if they were all teenagers again.

The photographer requested everyone join the bride and groom in the gardens for group photographs. For the final picture, all the guests were asked to stand in a large semi-circle behind the bride and groom. The photographer appeared at the open window of an attic room and everyone

smiled up from the lawn as he captured a shot of all the guests standing around the happy couple, all surrounded by the lovely gardens.

It was a beautiful day and when the men headed back inside to their drinks, Joanna and the other women from their table stayed outside. They sat on wrought iron chairs in the formal gardens and Joanna noticed the older man in the dark suit making his way across the lawn in their direction.

When he reached them he bowed his head slightly and smiled. “Would you ladies care to have a drink brought out to the garden?”

Helena answered first. “I loved the champagne we had for the toast. I don’t suppose there’s any of that left, is there?”

The man smiled and bowed his head again. “I will see what I can find.”

As he headed back across the lawn, Amanda frowned at Helena. “I think he was only offering to have a waiter bring the glasses from our table.”

Helena shrugged. “They’ll have turned warm by now. Besides, he obviously has the hots for a certain someone, so why not use that to our advantage?”

Joanna saw the others smile in her direction and was confused. “What are you talking about?”

Helena chuckled. “Him—the maître d, or whatever he is. Hasn’t been able to keep his eyes off you since we arrived at the hotel.”

Joanna was shocked. “You can’t be serious.”

Helena nodded. “I think you’re the only one who hasn’t noticed where his gaze has been all afternoon.”

Amanda put her hand on Joanna’s arm. “It’s hardly surprising, the way you look today.”

“But he’s old enough to—”

“Yeah, but not that old he couldn’t manage to!”

The other women laughed at Helena’s remark.

Joanna felt a little naïve for being so oblivious. She’d assumed he’d smiled at everyone, not only her.

She tried to justify his behaviour. “He’s being professional and doing his job, making guests feel comfortable.”

“Yeah, right.” Helena’s sarcasm brought a giggle from the other women. “I’m sure he is, but I suspect he’d like to make you a bit more comfortable than the rest of us.”

“Don’t be so—”

“It’s okay, Jo.” Amanda winked. “He’s quite sexy, a bit like Paul Newman as Butch Cassidy.”

Geraldine nodded her agreement. “Yeah, he’s got lovely blue eyes.”

Helena started humming *Raindrops are Falling on My Head*, but stopped and nodded towards the hotel. “Bingo.”

A young waiter was walking across the lawn towards them. On his tray were four crystal flutes, an ice-bucket and a bottle of champagne.

The women thanked him, and after Geraldine had filled their glasses the women toasted Joanna. “Cheers, Jo. Here’s to your tight dress and suntanned legs.”

Joanna smiled, slightly embarrassed, and took a sip of her drink.

The women spent the next hour enjoying their champagne in the beautiful garden. The warmth of the late afternoon sun and the freedom of not having to chase after two children gave Joanna a nice relaxed feeling. She couldn’t remember the last time she’d been able to unwind as much as this.

When the bottle was empty the women decided to make their way back inside. They found their men standing in the bar area—evidently the free booze had finally dried up and they’d had to buy their own. From the volume of their laughter and conversations, Joanna surmised they’d been drinking at a considerable rate. Gareth had removed his jacket, loosened his tie and rolled up his shirt sleeves.

His eyes were semi-glazed and when he saw Joanna he raised his glass and smiled. “You all right, doll? Fancy a drink?”

Joanna pulled him to one side, trying to speak without their friends overhearing. “Gareth, it’s not even five o’clock and you’re shit-faced.”

“Nah, I’m fine. Catching up with my mates, that’s all.”

Joanna looked up into his face. His pupils were dilated, and his breath smelt of cigarettes. “Have you been smoking?”

He shrugged. “Forgot my vape kit, and when Danny nipped out for a fag, I had a few drags to keep me going.”

She sighed, exasperated. She’d been begging him to give up for as long as she could remember. “Why don’t we have a cup of coffee or go for a walk in the grounds? Take a short break before the evening reception starts.”

Gareth was already pulling away from her, back towards the bar. “Nah, I hardly ever see these guys now. We’re just catching up and having a laugh. You can have a coffee and a walk if you like.”

Joanna watched him return to his friends. She understood it was nice to catch up on all their latest news—she’d spent an hour doing exactly the same thing. But whereas the girls had been happy to make a bottle of champagne split four ways last for an hour, the men seemed determined to drink themselves into a stupor. She decided to go back and sit with the girls.

As she left the bar area, she saw the man in the dark suit talking to two of the other guests. Without being entirely sure why, Joanna started walking towards him. He looked up and smiled as she approached and the other guests walked away, leaving them alone.

“Yes, madam?”

Joanna stalled, unsure of what she was going to say. She tucked a stray strand of her brown hair behind one ear. “Hi, I wanted to thank you for the champagne earlier.”

The man smiled, and she saw immediately what Amanda had meant about Paul Newman. His pale blue eyes seemed to twinkle with mischief and intelligence. “It was my pleasure. Is there anything else I can get for you?”

“No, thank you. I just wanted to say how grateful we were for the champagne.”

He smiled and bowed his head slightly. “Madam.”

As he was turning to leave, a thought occurred to Joanna. “Actually, there is something. Could you tell me where I can get a cup of coffee?”

“I can arrange that. Where would you like them to bring it?”

She felt guilty. “Oh no, that’s not necessary. I’m happy to go and order it, but I wondered if I should ask at the bar, or somewhere else.”

The man frowned and shook his head. “No, madam, it is something I will do. I will have a pot brought to you. We are here to serve.”

Joanna looked around and saw Helena and Geraldine watching from their table. She nodded in their direction. “I’ll be sitting back at the table.”

The man looked over and saw the other women. “Very well, I will have a large pot and more cups sent over.”

“Thank you...?” Joanna raised her eyebrows, wondering why she’d felt the need to ask his name.

“Reuben.”

She held his gaze for a split second, then smiled. “Thank you, Reuben.”

He walked off to make the arrangements and Joanna made her way towards her friends. They all looked a little wide-eyed as she sat down.

“I’ve ordered us all some coffee.” She’d tried to make it sound as matter-of-fact as she could, but knew the girls wouldn’t let it go.

Geraldine leaned close to whisper. “Surprised you didn’t ask him if he did room service.”

Helena chimed in. “Yes, Jo, I think he’d be more than happy to service you in your room.”

All of them sniggered and even though Joanna was discomfited, she couldn’t deny the warm glow inside, reminding her of how she’d felt as a teenager when she’d learned some boy fancied her.

The coffee was delivered by a young waitress a few minutes later and as Joanna started to pour, Amanda joined them.

“Have you seen the state of our husbands?”

The others uttered sounds of shared disapproval.

“I can’t believe they’re pissed already. Helena, I doubt Nigel will be able to score at both ends tonight. Sticking with your football analogy, you’ll be lucky if you can pull him off at half-time.”

The girls spent another half hour chatting idly before the hotel staff began rearranging the tables in preparation for the evening reception.

Amanda and Geraldine announced they were going back to their own rooms for a rest and to freshen up, but Joanna and Helena decided to go for another walk in the hotel grounds.

Once outside, both women made quick phone calls to check their kids were okay, and wandered off in the direction of the gazebo at the far end of the lawn. Joanna breathed in the early evening air, the smell from the lilac bushes sickly-sweet.

Helena turned round and looked back towards the hotel. Through the windows they could see guests arriving for the evening reception. “It’s nice to see Tony so happy again—I think his divorce hurt him very badly.”

“Yeah, he deserves some happiness.”

Helena smiled. “Okay, the champagne’s gone to my head, so I’m going to come clean. I used to fancy Tony when we were at school, and I was dead jealous when you went out with him.”

This brought a giggle from Joanna. “All the girls fancied Tony. We were young, and only went out for a few weeks. It was nothing serious to be jealous over.”

“What do you mean, nothing serious?”

Joanna shrugged. “Exactly that—we were just kids. He taught me how to French kiss, and I let him become the first boy to play with my boobs.”

Helena laughed, but Joanna could tell from her expression there was something on her mind.

“What is it?”

Helena took a breath, looked to the sky. “We had a fling when we were at university.”

Joanna was shocked—not so much at the revelation, but because it had been kept secret for so long. “But you two didn’t go to the same university.” As if that mattered.

Helena nodded. “I know, but we were both in London. We bumped into each other at a Student’s Union bar where a couple of bands were playing. We were both pissed and ended up snogging.”

Joanna laughed, but part of her felt a little cheated—Tony had been her childhood squeeze. “Did he still French kiss?”

Helena snorted. “He put more than his tongue in my mouth, and I let him do a lot more than play with my tits.”

“Helena, you are such a slut!”

“I know, I know. But we were drunk and horny nineteen-year-olds. And I’d fancied him for years.”

“Does Nigel know about it?”

Helena looked surprised by the question. “Yeah, of course he does. It was before we’d started dating, but he knows about everything I did before we got together.”

Joanna looked back through the windows. “His new wife’s very pretty.”

“Yeah, and she’s only twenty-six. I reckon Tony’s going to be getting more sex tonight than either of us two, the state our husbands are going to be in.”

Joanna sighed. She was so angry at Gareth. This was her first chance to relax, unwind and enjoy herself, and he’d decided to get drunk instead.

“Come on.” Helena took Joanna by the hand. “Let’s go back inside. I haven’t danced in ages—I might get Tony up on the dancefloor and see if his backside’s still as firm as it used to be.”

Joanna laughed. “He’s got a beautiful young wife now, so he won’t be interested in some tired old slapper he’s already used and abused.”

Helena looked at her friend and smiled sweetly. “Bitch.”

Inside they found Amanda and Geraldine in the lobby chatting to another couple of people they’d known years before. These were new arrivals—invited to the evening reception. Amanda caught Joanna’s eye and beckoned her to one side.

Joanna was concerned. “What’s wrong?”

“Apparently Gareth’s been sick. Danny’s taken him back to your room for a clean-up and lie down.”

Joanna was livid. “He is such a dickhead. I can’t believe it—the first day and night on our own for five years, and he drinks himself into a coma.

The twat.”

“I’m sorry, babe.” Amanda slipped her arms around Joanna and gave her a comforting hug. “We’ll have a nice night, who needs men?”

Helena lowered her voice. “If I’d known our husbands were going to revert back to teenagers for the weekend, I’d have packed my vibrator.”

Amanda giggled. “Maybe we should have kept the champagne bottle for you to use.”

The women made their way back to the main ballroom. The furniture had been moved, the tables and chairs now around the perimeter, the centre of the room cleared for dancing. The women found an empty table near the windows and placed their bags and phones there. Noticing another bar had been opened at the back of the room, Joanna and Helena went to order a couple of bottles of wine. Soon they were all on the dancefloor, having a great time. There was no sign of any of their husbands. Joanna assumed Gareth was passed out in their room, and the others were probably staying in the bar to avoid the wrath of their wives. The number of people in the room had more than doubled as the evening guests arrived, and the mood was typical for a wedding—everyone laughing and happy. Other people they knew had arrived and the four women were forced farther apart as more of their friends joined the dancefloor.

When the DJ put on a song Joanna didn’t particularly like, she decided to go to the loo. On her way back towards her friends, she saw Reuben standing in the corridor near reception. Without considering her actions, she headed straight for him.

He watched her approach, bowed his head slightly when she stopped in front of him. “Madam.”

“Hello, Reuben.”

This brought a big smile to his face. “I trust you are enjoying your evening?”

Joanna wondered if he’d been involved in organising the cleaning up after Gareth. “I’m having a very pleasant time with friends I don’t see as often as I’d like.”

Reuben nodded his understanding. “That is a good way to spend an evening, yes?”

“Can I buy you a drink?” The offer was out before Joanna thought about what she was saying.

Reuben smiled apologetically. “Unfortunately, I am not allowed to be seen drinking whilst working. But I am due to have a break, so perhaps I could have a coffee while you have your drink?”

“A coffee would be fine for me, too.”

“Very good—I shall order us a pot. Perhaps we could sit in the orangery while we drink it?”

Joanna’s eyes opened wide. “Ooh, that sounds a bit posh.”

Reuben shook his head, smiling. “It’s actually a small room with many windows and plants, but it a very nice room. Come, follow me.”

Joanna glanced over her shoulder towards the ballroom to see if any of her friends were looking her way. She didn’t suppose it would matter—she was only having a coffee.

Reuben stopped to speak to one of the girls at the reception desk, presumably ordering their coffee, then led the way down a short corridor. He opened a door and stood aside to allow Joanna to enter the room first. It was exactly as he’d described—a small room with windows down two walls, and lots of plants, some in large terracotta pots, others hanging from hooks in the ceiling. There were orchids, cacti, rubber plants, ferns, and many others Joanna didn’t recognise. The floor was old quarry tiles, and there were several wicker chairs and tables placed around the room. The only other people in the room were what appeared to be two members of the kitchen staff, wearing white tops and checked trousers, having a cold drink during their break.

Reuben nodded to the men and walked to the table at the far side of the room. He held out a chair for Joanna. “Madam.”

Joanna smiled and sat down and looked up at him. “Since you’re now officially on your break, you can call me Joanna.”

He smiled as he took the chair opposite her. “Thank you, I would like that. Joanna is a very beautiful name.”

Joanna loved the way he pronounced her name; Yohanna.

“Where are you from, Reuben?”

“From Slovenia. I grew up in Maribor, the second largest city there.”

Joanna was uncomfortable. “Would you think me terribly stupid if I admitted I’m not sure where that is?”

He smiled again, his blue eyes sparkling in the low lights. “Of course not. It is a small country that has Italy to the west, Austria to the north, Hungary to the east, and Croatia to the south. Up until about twenty five years ago it was part of Yugoslavia.”

Joanna nodded. “Thank you. Do you miss it?”

He half-closed his eyes and tilted his head slightly to one side. “A little.”

“How long have you been over here?”

As he was about to answer, the door opened and a young waiter delivered a tray holding a coffee pot, two cups and a plate of home-made petit-fours. Reuben thanked him and poured the coffee.

“I left there fifteen years ago. I worked in Germany for three years, and in Scotland for five years. I have been here in England for almost seven years.” He raised his eyebrows. “Sugar?”

“Not for me, thanks.” Joanna crossed her legs, and she saw Reuben’s eyes glance down at the exposed flesh. It gave her a warm feeling inside. “And what about the name Reuben—is that a Slovenian name?”

He shook his head, unable to answer straight away as his mouth was full of coffee. He swallowed. “No, I think it is a Hebrew name. In the Bible, Reuben was the eldest son of Jacob and Leah.”

Joanna’s face froze in a half-smile. Although her knowledge of geography was limited, her knowledge of the Bible was almost non-existent. “Er...”

Reuben smiled. “He had a younger half-brother called Joseph, who had a coat of many colours.”

Joanna laughed out loud. “Thank you. I have heard of that one.”

He leaned closer. “My mother used to tell me that Reuben was the one who persuaded his brothers that rather than murder Joseph, they should just throw him in a pit. I think that means he was one of the good guys.”

Joanna frowned. “I don’t think good guys throw their brothers into a pit.”

Reuben laughed. “Perhaps you’re right. My mother was trying to convince me it was a noble name.”

“It’s a lovely name. I don’t think I’ve ever met another Reuben before.”

He smiled and nodded.

Joanna watched his face. He looked suddenly bashful, and she found it endearing. She remembered Helena’s comment about him wanting to service her in her room, and felt a warmth between her legs.

She sipped her coffee. “Do you enjoy your work?”

“Yes. Of course there are some aspects you enjoy more than others, but it is a nice job.” He held eye contact for a few seconds. “I get to meet lovely people like yourself.”

Joanna smiled. “But you probably also have to deal with awkward people...” Her mind flashed to Gareth trying to order too many bottles of wine, and wondered if Reuben was aware of the problem with him being sick.

“It is true, but the majority are very nice. As you can imagine, a hotel such as this caters for many occasions. Some are more pleasant than others, where the good guests far outnumber the difficult guests.”

“Which are the worst?” She was being bewitched by his accent, and his eyes.

“Works’ Christmas parties are often difficult, where it appears that all the guests want to do is drink as much as possible and be as rude to each other as they can.”

“And the best?”

“Weddings. Weddings are my favourite. They are joyous occasions—as they should be—and everyone is in a happy mood.”

This brought a frown to her face. “I’m afraid my husband must think he’s on a works do, because he’s drank himself into a state and made a complete fool of himself.”

Reuben shrugged. “Young men are allowed to be a little over-exuberant.”

“He’s not that young. He’s thirty-four and should know better.”

He nodded his understanding. “I’m sure he will be sorry in the morning.”

Joanna held eye contact for a few seconds, wondering if there was hidden meaning in his words. Did he mean because of the hangover, or because of what his wife had done while he was passed out? “What’s special about weddings?”

Reuben took a breath and paused, as if considering whether or not to admit something. He leaned a little closer again. “The women are always very pleasing on the eye.”

Joanna smiled, but wasn’t sure what he was getting at. Again she wondered if there was more to interpret from his words. “I think the brides are supposed to be pleasing on the eye.”

“No, no. Yes, the brides are beautiful. Always. It is the best day of their life, and everyone looks at the bride, so she has to be at her most beautiful. But what I mean is, the women guests are very pleasing. They always make a special effort, take time with their dress, shoes, hair and makeup. They even paint their fingernails, which they probably don’t do every day. I call them the ‘wedding belles’—the beautiful women who come to celebrate their friends’ marriage.”

She hesitated while she thought about what he’d said. “Don’t the female guests at a works party take the same care in getting dressed up?”

He shook his head. “No, I don’t believe so. Sometimes they dress in very revealing outfits and behave more audaciously, but they are not the same as the women at a wedding. There is more happiness at a wedding, and it shows as a kind of radiance within the guests.”

“Are we radiant?” Joanna tried to calm the butterflies in her stomach.

Reuben turned serious. “Joanna, you transcend radiance by many magnitudes.”

She squeezed her legs together, felt the wetness. Her heart was beating hard in her chest. “Reuben, do you live here in the hotel?”

He held her gaze for a few seconds, looked a little disappointed.
“No, I have an apartment in town.”

“Is there anywhere in the hotel we could go now, that’s private?”
She was propositioning a man who was probably old enough to be her father, but she didn’t care. She felt so alive, she didn’t give a single thought to Gareth in their room, or even her children at her sister’s house.

Reuben frowned and started to shake his head, but then his eyebrows went up like he’d had an epiphany. He stared at her.

She half-smiled, excited. “What?”

Reuben took a set of keys from his jacket pocket. “I have the keys to the attic room. The photographer handed them to me after the pictures in the garden had been taken.”

Joanna’s pulse accelerated and her throat constricted slightly. “What sort of room is it?”

He paused, his eyes never leaving hers. “It’s a bedroom.”

Joanna stood up. “Show me.”

He stood and led her out of the orangery. They bypassed the reception desk and entered a narrow set of stairs near the back of the building. They went up two flights, and on each stair Joanna told herself that if she didn’t stop this now, there would be no going back. But she kept following Reuben. She looked down at her legs pushing through the gap in her skirt, her feet in the sandals. She was a wedding belle. She’d spent months getting her figure back ready for today, and spent a lot of money on her dress and shoes, had her legs waxed, taken ages with her makeup and nails, and Gareth had been too immature to appreciate any of that.

Reuben stopped her at the top of the stairs and poked his head through a door. Seeing the coast was clear, he beckoned her forward and they walked a few yards along one of the normal corridors until they reached another door. Through there and up another flight of narrow stairs led to a single door. Reuben took the keys from his pocket and unlocked it. He pushed the door open and stepped back, allowing Joanna to go in first.

The room was illuminated by the spotlights strategically placed around the garden and aimed up at the back of the building. The ceiling sloped in to follow the shape of the roof, giving the room a cosy feel.

Joanna stood at the foot of the large bed and looked at his face. This was her last chance to stop herself. “Do you do this sort of thing with many of the wedding belles, Reuben?”

He slowly shook his head. “I have never even had a cup of coffee with one of them.”

Joanna tilted her head to one side. “Why me?”

She saw him bite his lip as his eyes took her in, from head to toe. “When I first saw you, I couldn’t take my eyes off you. You looked so perfect, so full of everything that should be there. The beauty is there for everyone to see, but also your poise, your actions. You look refined, elegant, comfortable in yourself without being aloof. I think it is rare that one person has all these attributes.”

Joanna was shocked, but very flattered. Even if it was part of his patter, it was still nice to hear. And he didn’t need to say it—she’d already made it obvious why she was here.

“I’ve never... Before, I mean. This isn’t something I’ve ever...”

Reuben took a step closer. “I don’t want you to do something you don’t want to do.”

She stared into the blue of his eyes. “I won’t.”

“What I mean is, I don’t want you to regret—”

Joanna stepped forward and kissed him on the mouth. She slid her hands inside his jacket and wrapped her arms around his back, pleasantly surprised at the firmness of his body. They kissed passionately, both breathing heavily. When she eased his jacket back off his shoulders, he broke the kiss, removed the jacket and dropped it to the floor. She undid the knot of his tie while his hands rested on her waist, his fingers gently tracing over the fabric. She leaned forward and kissed him on the chin and around the mouth. She could smell his cologne. Once the tie was undone she left it hanging around his neck and started to undo the buttons of his shirt.

Reuben ran his hands slowly up her sides and cupped her breasts in his hands, eliciting a groan from somewhere deep in her throat. His shirt now hung open and she could see his chest, a smattering of black and grey hairs.

He moved his hands around to the back of her neck and found the zip. They stared into each other's eyes as he slowly pulled downwards. When the zip had been opened all the way, Joanna stepped back and stood in front of him. Then she dipped her shoulders and let the dress fall forward and down. It slid silently to the floor, leaving her in only her white sandals and dark blue silk thong. No bra with this dress: her breasts were quite small, and she hadn't wanted the straps showing.

Reuben's eyes opened wide as he stared at her body. His mouth was slightly open, giving him a sort of shocked expression.

She waited for him to say or do something, but he kept looking at her body as if memorising every small detail. She'd never felt so desired. She stepped close and undid his belt, opened his trousers. As her hand pulled the zip down, she felt the bulge of his hardness. She stroked her thumb against it through his shorts and felt him shiver.

His hands returned to her breasts, this time squeezing her nipples. Another groan escaped her lips. Even though her boobs were small, they were extremely sensitive. She tilted her head up and kissed him again, very gently. He placed his arms on her waist and moved her back to the bed. When the backs of her legs touched it, she sat down and crawled backward to the middle of the bed.

Reuben discarded the rest of his clothes except for his white cotton shorts, and joined her on the bed. He knelt by her feet and carefully unbuckled each sandal in turn, then looked up and down her body. He placed his fingertips on her feet and stroked them, moving from the toes to the instep, around to the soles and back to the toes. Next he stroked her ankles, up and around her calves, down her shins to her ankles again.

"You're beautiful."

She watched his face. He never took his eyes away from whatever part of her he was stroking. He moved up to her knees, then her thighs. Joanna parted her legs to allow him access to her inner thighs, his fingers tracing small circles on the soft skin.

He didn't touch her crotch at all, instead sliding his hands up and over the swell of her hips. He moved further up and re-visited her breasts, this time spending over a minute gently pulling and twisting her nipples.

Joanna was desperate to be taken, but this sort of foreplay wasn't something she'd had in a long time—if ever. Nobody had made such a point of wanting to touch and caress every part of her. She stared at Reuben's shorts. She could see his erection pushing against the material, but she could also see a damp stain where he was leaking precum. It turned her on to know he was so aroused simply from looking at her, stroking her.

He put a hand under her shoulder and another under her bum, and gently rolled her over until she was lying face down. His fingers ran through her hair, stroked her ears, neck, shoulders. As he ran his hands slowly down her back, he nuzzled the nape of her neck. He moved his mouth close to her ear, his breath raising goosebumps.

“You are very beautiful.” His voice was an intimate whisper. “So perfect.”

His hands continued to stroke her, moving down her spine, only briefly lingering on her bum before they travelled down the backs of her legs.

Joanna sighed with each caress, but the pressure seemed to be building to an unbearable intensity inside, and she needed to release it.

Reuben started to stroke up her legs again, and as his hands reached above her knees, Joanna pushed her legs further apart. His hands slid up her inner thighs, and she was sure he'd be able to feel the slick dampness his touches had induced. Finally he touched her in the way she craved. He pushed his hand between her legs and cupped her mons, applying gentle pressure. She moaned and pushed down against his hand, thrusting her hips in an attempt to generate friction.

He allowed her to do this for only a few seconds, then removed his hand. His fingers slipped into the waistband of her thong and she raised herself off the bed enough to let him roll the sodden garment down her legs.

Joanna lay face down on the bed, completely naked and thighs parted. Elsewhere in the same building, her husband was passed out from drinking and her friends would be wondering where she was, but none of those things seemed important now. The second she felt Reuben's teeth grazing over her bum cheek, she let out another sigh.

When his finger slid between her wet outer lips, her toes curled down. He stroked slowly from front to back, the soft folds of her flesh slick with her juices. He repeated the action—two, three times, never actually going far enough forward to make any contact with her aching clit. On the fourth stroke, he continued his course back and traced small circles around the sensitive puckered buttonhole of her anus.

By now she was so desperate to be fucked, she'd have let him put anything wherever he wanted to. She pushed herself back towards his fingers, hoping for some penetration wherever she could get it.

Reuben rolled her over onto her back, and they held eye contact in silence.

She parted her legs again, willing him to fuck her. His face was serious, and his hand slid down between her legs again. He traced his finger once more through the labia, swollen like a flower in bloom. She thought briefly of the orchids in the orangery, then she thought of her friends' comments about getting serviced in a room. He bent over her and kissed her on the mouth, very gently, before moving down her body to suck each nipple. He seemed to take an age doing this, all the time sliding his fingertip gently between her outer lips.

Reuben lowered his head between her legs and closed his lips around her clit. Joanna gasped and pushed herself up to meet his mouth. He moved the flat of his tongue slowly over the hard flesh and she seemed to dissolve inside as the climax swept through her. She arched her back off the bed, and as she did so he pushed two fingers deep inside her, curling them to press against her g-spot. She screamed in ecstasy and lights seemed to flash behind her eyelids. She gripped his hair, pulling his mouth harder against her, grinding her crotch against his face as the ripples continued to send shockwaves throughout her entire body. Eventually, the feelings faded and she released her grip on his hair. She slowly opened her eyes.

Reuben sat up and stared at her. He smiled, his eyes sparkling, but the colour of them not discernible in the shadows of the unlit bedroom.

Joanna reached up and pulled him down onto the bed next to her. She leaned over him, kissed him gently on the lips, tasting her own essence. "Thank you. That was wonderful."

He bowed his head slightly. "I should be the one to thank you. I have never seen such beauty this close before."

Joanna's mind flashed back to Gareth looking down at her leg by the table. 'She'll be getting it later.' *Too fucking right I will.*

She knelt up and pulled Reuben's shorts down, releasing his cock. It was still hard, the head completely covered with precum. Keeping her eyes on his, she lowered her head and took him into her mouth. He let out a sigh as her lips enveloped him, and when she squeezed the base with her hand and moved her tongue over the domed head, he closed his eyes. Joanna sucked and licked him for only a short time—no more than thirty seconds—because she wanted to feel him inside her. She wanted this man to fuck her, even though it was wrong, and would make her an adulteress. She was on the pill, and didn't give a second thought to the other aspect of safe sex.

She straightened up on her knees, straddling him. Placing the tip of his cock at her entrance, she stared into his eyes for a few seconds before slowly lowering herself onto him. Both of them moaned as his hardness slid all the way into her wetness. She held herself still and clenched around him. He moved his hands up and cupped her breasts, his fingers teasing her nipples.

Joanna started to thrust forward and back on his cock, twisting her body as he impaled her. He let out a groan and gripped her hips, moving her on him. She leaned forward, placing her hands on the bed either side of his head, her small breasts shaking with her movements. The tingle deep in her stomach announced the beginnings of another orgasm. She gritted her teeth and pumped her hips, using the friction of his pubic bone on her clit to speed her towards the finish.

Suddenly Reuben cried out and pushed his hips up, lifting her off the bed. He was coming inside her, and knowing this was enough to send her crashing through her second climax, every nerve-ending shooting signals to her brain. She collapsed on top of him and he wrapped his arms around her, his hands gripping the cheeks of her backside as he kept pumping his hips from beneath, finishing his own ride of pleasure.

They stilled and lay in silence, her breasts crushed against his chest, her head on his shoulder. He stroked her back gently. Eventually she raised

herself up and sat on the bed next to him. She looked over her shoulder into his face, and he smiled.

She took a breath. “I need to get into our room, but my card key is in my bag in the ballroom. Do you have a master key?”

Reuben shook his head. “I have no access to any of the rooms, but I can get you a card. What room are you in?”

“205.”

Reuben stood and started to dress. Joanna did the same.

“I just need to check on my husband.” She looked into his eyes.

He nodded, looking sad. “Of course.” He concentrated on fastening his shirt.

“Reuben?”

He raised his head, looking concerned.

“I’m not regretting what we’ve just done. I’m only going to my room so I can use it as an excuse for my absence to my friends.”

Reuben nodded, looking relieved.

She smiled. “But I’ll also need a clean pair of panties.”

Reuben smiled too, slipped on his jacket and knotted his tie. “I will meet you back here in a few minutes. Room 205, yes?”

Joanna nodded. “Yes please. Thank you.”

Reuben left and Joanna zipped up her dress and put on her shoes. She combed her fingers through her hair and looked down at herself—she’d do until she got to her own room.

He returned with a card key and they locked the attic room and headed down the first flight of stairs.

They stopped by the closed door, and she kissed him gently. “I’ll always treasure what we’ve just done.”

He nodded and swallowed. “As will I. Thank you Joanna, you have made an old man very happy.”

She laughed, stroked the lapel of his jacket. “You’re not an old man, and you certainly made me very happy.” She smiled, embarrassed. “Twice.”

Reuben opened the door and stood aside as she walked past him. Joanna joined the hallway to the guest rooms and he continued down the

remaining flights of stairs.

The new card opened their door, and Joanna was hit by the smell of vomit. The light in the bathroom was on, and she could make out Gareth's form lying on the bed. He still had on his shirt, trousers and shoes. His tie and jacket were on a chair in the corner, both splattered with vomit. Joanna looked down at him in disgust. She was tempted to remove her thong and stand over his head and let Reuben's juices drip from her onto his face, thinking it would serve him right.

Instead she took a clean pair of panties from the drawer and went into the bathroom. She quickly mopped away most of their sex juices, put on the clean underwear and washed her hands. She regarded her reflection in the mirror. There was no doubt she had a healthy glow, and she hoped that by now Helena would be too drunk to notice. She re-applied some lipstick, then made her way back downstairs.

All the women were still dancing, and Joanna joined them.

Helena moved closer and leaned over to shout in her ear. "Are you okay?"

Joanna nodded. "Just been to survey the damage. Any chance you can convince Nigel to share a vomit-filled room with Gareth so you and me can share your four-poster bed?"

Helena smiled sexily. "That's probably the best offer I've had in a long time. Maybe we should try and get Tony to join us for old times' sake."

Joanna looked over and saw him dancing close to his pretty young bride. "I don't think he's going to be interested in a couple of old slappers like us."

Helena laughed. "Yeah, well, it's his loss."

Joanna closed her eyes and danced, letting herself get lost in the music.





Unbridled Passion

“So, what time were... taking the... for tomorrow?” The speaker on the hands-free kept crackling.

“I’m sorry Olivia, you keep cutting out.” Leanne checked the rear view mirror as she manoeuvred the Range Rover Evoque through the narrow country lanes. “I’m just about to pick the girls up from their riding lesson, and the phone signal up here’s awful.”

“Would it ... the...?”

“I’ll phone you when I get home, Liv. Sorry darling, but the phone’s not working, and I think I’ve taken a wrong turn.”

Leanne ended the call and looked around. She hadn’t been here for a long time, and couldn’t really remember the way. Tilly’s parents usually dropped the girls off in the morning, and Marcus did the pick-up. But Marcus was spending the day being entertained by clients at Ascot, which meant Leanne had needed to forego her Pilates class to collect the girls. She hadn’t thought to look up the postcode to put into her sat nav.

As she drove a little further along the lane, the tall hedge gave way to a wooden fence, giving her a clear view across the fields. In the distance, Leanne could see the large outbuilding that housed the riding arena. She was obviously on the wrong approach road, but hoped she could get there without needing to turn around on such a narrow lane.

A few hundred yards farther down the lane, she saw a metal five-bar gate blocking a dirt-track, which seemed to cut through the fields towards the riding school. She could see there was just a spring-catch fastening the gate to the post—no lock. The verge wasn’t wide enough to pull over, but since she hadn’t seen any other traffic in the last ten minutes, she decided to

risk blocking the road for the short time it took her to open the gate. She flicked on the hazard lights and got out of her car.

The verge was wet and muddy. Leanne looked down in horror at the dirty water seeping into the black suede of her shoes. She got the gate open and once back inside her car, glanced at her shoes. The three-inch stiletto heels were caked in wet mud. *At least they're not my Christian Louboutin's.*

She pulled onto the track and considered whether to close the gate behind her. She certainly didn't want to risk getting her shoes any dirtier, and couldn't see any animals in the field that might make a run for it. Besides, she'd be driving back out in twenty minutes or so.

As she drove slowly down the dirt track, she was glad of the suspension on her SUV. The track seemed to be heading away from the large building of the riding school and towards some smaller outbuildings. She reached a yard and stopped the car, frustrated. The riding school barn roof was just visible over the brow of a hill, maybe three hundred yards away, but she couldn't work out how to get to it.

Leanne got out of her car and the smell made her flinch. The doors of two of the outbuildings stood ajar. Apart from the birdsong, it was spookily quiet. She walked across the yard, avoiding the piles of dirt and hen shit as she went. She poked her head inside the first building. There were sacks of grain piled on pallets against the far wall, but no sign of life. She walked along the yard to the next open door, seeing hay bales lined up all around the walls as if used for seating. At the back was a collection of big wooden boxes, and another door which seemed to lead to a smaller room. She thought she could hear running water.

"Hello?" She waited for a few seconds, then called again. "Anybody there?"

No answer.

Watching where she put her feet, and taking care to avoid touching the cobweb-covered doorjamb with her charcoal angora sweater, Leanne crossed the barn towards the inner door. Just as she got within a couple of feet, a man carrying two buckets of water marched through.

Leanne squealed, and the man dropped one of the buckets, splashing water everywhere.

“Oh, God!” Leanne glared at the man, whose expression was one of shock.

He lifted his hand and pulled out iPod earbuds. “What’re you doing in here?”

“Getting my clothes ruined, that’s what.” Her black suede shoes were now completely soaked, as were her tights. There were also several splashes up her knee-length burgundy skirt.

The guy nodded at her legs. “Well, what d’you expect if you creep around a barn? Besides, you shouldn’t be wearing clothes like that on a farm.”

Taking a deep breath, Leanne tried to calm herself. “I’m sorry, but what should I call you?”

“Others call me Doug, but you can call me whatever you like.” He winked, looking down at her breasts in the tight-fitting sweater.

Leanne glared at him with disdain. “Right. Well, *Doug*, I had no intention of coming to a farm. I’m trying to find the riding school.”

“I don’t think you should be riding a horse in those clothes either, although I wouldn’t mind watching you get in the saddle.” He winked at her again.

“I’m picking my daughter up from her riding lesson. I have no intention of climbing up on a horse so perverts like you can get a cheap thrill.”

The man grinned, openly ogling her body. “Oh well, that’s a shame.” He picked up the bucket he’d dropped and went to fill it again.

Leanne couldn’t believe his rudeness. “I want the riding school.”

The man continued into the other room and Leanne followed him. There was a single tap attached to a wall: other than that, the small room was completely empty. He placed the bucket on the floor and turned on the tap.

“Excuse me, but if you’d just answer my question, then I’ll get out of your way.” Leanne crossed her arms over her chest.

“You didn’t ask me a question.”

“What?”

The man was watching the water level, stealing glances at her legs now she'd blocked his view of her tits. He turned the tap off and looked up at her. "I said, you didn't ask me a question."

"Yes I did."

The man carried the bucket back through to the barn. Leanne followed him, trying her hardest not to lose her temper. *Maybe he's a bit simple.*

He was probably around her own age—maybe a little older, possibly forty. He wore a checked shirt and black jeans tucked into leather work boots. His brown hair was curly and a down to his collar, and from the length of his stubble, she guessed he hadn't shaved in a few days.

Leanne sighed. "Look, are you going to tell me or not? I really don't have time to waste if the question's too complicated for you."

The guy met her gaze briefly, then made a point of letting his eyes wander down her body again.

Leanne straightened, her feet a step apart, placing her hands on her hips and inviting him to ogle all he wanted. "Would you like me to turn around, so you can get a good look at my backside as well?"

He snorted. "I don't know what you're complaining about. Wanting to be looked at is the reason you're wearing those clothes."

"*What?*" Leanne was incredulous. "You think I wear nice clothes so that people like you can get an eyeful?"

Doug shrugged. "What other reason is there?"

There was no point in trying to explain how civilised people acted and dressed, so Leanne just shook her head. "Look, could you just tell me if I can get to the riding school from here, or if I need to go back to the road and drive all the way round to the other entrance?"

Doug took a final look at her legs, then nodded. "There's a track."

"Thank you. Would it be too much trouble for you to show me where it is?"

"No, I can do that." Doug led the way out of the building and pointed to a gate in the far corner of the yard. "That's the way you want to go."

Leanne strode back to her car. Just within feet of her door, her foot got caught on something and she almost fell over. She looked down to see her heel trapped in the metal cover of a six-inch square grid. “*Fuck!*”

Doug ambled towards her, a huge grin on his face. “You don’t want to be standing on grids wearing shoes like that.”

Leanne ignored him. She slipped her foot out of the shoe and, balancing on one leg, tried to retrieve it from the grid. She wobbled as she bent, but was reluctant to put her foot on the filthy, gritty ground. She’d spent over thirty pounds on her tights, and their fine denier would surely rip at the slightest contact with the rough concrete.

Doug leaned down and grabbed the shoe, pulling the cover of the grid free as he did so. The heel was stuck about halfway through the metal grill, the suede on the side of it badly ripped.

She took a breath, wanting to cry. “Could you please try and free the shoe, then I can go and pick up my daughter?”

Doug tried to pull it out, but it was stuck fast. “I’ve got a hammer in there, I’ll go and try to knock it out from below.” He looked down at her hand, which was holding onto his arm for balance.

Leanne snatched her hand back—she hadn’t realised she’d been hanging on to him. As she did so, she lost her balance and had to put her stockinged foot down on the concrete, narrowly missing a pellet of chicken shit.

She saw Doug smirk as he made his way back towards the door. She was getting tired of his stupid grinning and snide comments. She limped after him, trying to control her rage.

Doug took a toolbox from a shelf on the back wall. “Your daughter, is she Jasmine or Cassandra?”

“No, Portia.”

He smirked again, “Yeah, ’course she is.”

Leanne suspected he didn’t know any of the girls’ names, but was just being facetious. She had to bite her tongue and wait for him to return her shoe.

Holding the grid cover upside down, he tapped at the bottom of the heel with the hammer. After a few increasingly forceful hits, the shoe

finally fell to the floor, landing in a pile of sawdust.

Leanne limped over and stuffed it back on her foot. She glared at Doug. “I’m guessing you don’t spend much time with women from a different background to your own.”

The smirk returned to his face. “I don’t know anything about your background, and you don’t know anything about mine.”

“Oh, I think I know enough.”

“Go on then, tell me about my background.”

She stared at him. He had very green eyes, she noticed. “Okay, I’d say you were of below-average intellect, with a very low sense of ambition. You have an unskilled job, and have probably only ever been employed as a labourer. You seem to think it’s acceptable to ogle women, even the ones that are obviously beyond you. You’re rude and have probably never spent any time in the company of educated women, who appreciate interesting conversation.” She shook her highlighted hair back from her face and waited for his reply, which she expected to be short and gruff.

He nodded a couple of times. “Now is it my turn?”

“What?”

“I said, do you want me to tell you what I see when I look at you?”

Leanne gave a sarcastic laugh. “I’d be surprised if you’d managed to see any further than my tits and legs. They seem to have held your attention for most of the time I’ve been here.”

“Don’t forget your backside.”

“I really don’t think—”

“No, I know. But let me try, anyway.” His smirk gave way to a friendlier smile.

She liked the lines at the side of his eyes and realised that if he showered and shaved, he could probably be fairly attractive. “Oh, very well.”

Doug sat on one of the hay bales around the edge of the room. “You’re not stupid, but you’re not the sharpest knife in the drawer, either.”

Leanne’s jaw dropped. The cheeky...

“You probably did quite well at school, and went to university thinking you were something special. But when you got there, you realised everyone else was just as bright, or even brighter. But you had your looks, which even now, almost twenty years later, are probably still something you use to get your own way.”

Leanne allowed herself a self-satisfied smile. “So, you admit that you like the way I look?”

Doug shook his head, smiling. “That’s not important. You probably graduated with an average degree, but, again because of your looks and overwhelming self-confidence, you found a job easily enough. I originally thought you may have worked in HR, but you’re particularly bad at handling people. But then again, I’ve known some people in HR who were truly atrocious at dealing with people.”

Leanne frowned. She was beginning to realise she’d been wrong about his intellect. He certainly didn’t talk like a labourer, and his assumption about her being in the top five percent at school then mid-table at university was very accurate. She held her breath, waiting for his next revelation.

Doug leaned against the wall, crossing one leg so his foot rested on his other knee. “Maybe you studied business, marketing, or advertising....”

Leanne knew he was watching her face for a reaction and tried to retain a neutral expression.

He narrowed his eyes slightly. “Journalism? Media studies?” He laughed at whatever reaction he’d seen in her face. “Am I right?”

“I graduated in media and communication, and worked for six years in public relations.”

“PR. Yeah, I can see that.”

He looked very pleased with himself. His eyes seemed to sparkle when he laughed—a laugh which Leanne found slightly less annoying now.

“So, I’m guessing while you were working you met your husband. What’s his name, by the way?”

“Marcus.” Leanne had answered without thinking, regretting it as soon as his name was out of her mouth.

He nodded. “Marcus. He probably went to public school, got into Cambridge or Oxford and now works in finance. Is he a *banker*?”

She pursed her lips at his emphasis and implied rhyme with ‘wanker’. “He’s a hedge fund manager for a private investment company.”

Doug was nodding. “Yeah, he’d be the perfect catch for someone like you. No need to go back to work after having Portia, or does she a brother? Fabian, maybe? Hugo?”

Leanne glared at him.

“Well, I’m sure Portia is enough on her own. And now, you have all the free time you need to pamper yourself. You dress in your fine clothes, waste your days with visits to the spa for a pedicure and massage, lunch with the ladies...”

“It’s a lot more fun than shovelling horse shit, I can assure you.”

“Yeah, I’m sure it is. So, if your life’s so fine and dandy, why do you walk around with a constant sneer on those pretty lips?”

Leanne was too shocked to reply. She hadn't thought of herself as someone who walked around sneering. She just got frustrated by life, sometimes, like everyone else. She felt small under his knowing gaze, then angry about being made to feel like a nobody. How dare he pick her life apart like that? She looked good because she worked at it. And most people would love her lifestyle.

“I’m guessing it’s because Marcus doesn’t do it for you between the sheets.”

“You don’t know—”

“Ooh, that got a reaction.” Doug placed both feet on the floor and he sat slightly forward.

“He’s more of a man than—”

“Yeah, I’m sure he is. But I don’t think he’s man enough for you. I get the impression that the highlight of your week is when your tennis coach flirts with you. And while you’re in the sauna, you probably fantasise about getting poked by the ski instructor in Klosters.”

Leanne decided the best form of defence was attack. “Is this how you behave every time you see something unobtainable?”

“Unobtainable?”

“Yes, dearie. Or to put it in *layman’s* terms, out of your fucking league.”

Doug laughed out loud. “Jesus, you really think you’re something special, don’t you? Let me tell you, darling, wrapping something up in expensive paper doesn’t make it a special gift.”

Leanne balled her hands into fists. “Special gift or not, it’s a damn-sight better than you’ve ever had. Or deserve.”

“Maybe when you pick up Portia, you should look at the women who ride the horses.” He nodded at her clothes. “They don’t need to dress like that, but they’ve got bodies as good as yours. And their muscle-tone is built up from real work, not from an aerobics class. They know how to control something big and powerful between their legs, not some chinless wonder who works in the city.”

His comment hit her for six. She’d actually convinced Marcus to grow a goatee in a bid to conceal his weak chin. “Well, chinless or not, he gets to sleep with me every night. Maybe you can think about that while you’re jerking yourself off in your hovel later.”

Doug laughed out loud again. “I’m glad to see your PR skills haven’t left you completely.”

“Fuck off!”

“I trust you don’t use language like that in front of your butler.”

Leanne took a step closer so she was looking down at him. “No, I save words like that for the uncouth bastards I meet.”

“And the ski instructors.” He seemed to be enjoying this.

She smiled, her anger dissipating a little. “Oh yes, I whisper words like that to the ski instructors all the time.” She felt a little shaky, but knew it wasn’t just down to anger. He was having an effect on her.

He smiled back. “But only off-piste?”

She narrowed her eyes. “Well, it’s one of the advantages of being a ski instructor.”

He raised his hand and put it on the inside of her leg, just above the knee.

Her eyes opened wide in shock, but there seemed to be an electric current flowing through his touch. “What do you think you’re doing?”

“Nothing.” He gave her leg a light squeeze and moved his hand upward, but only slightly. Barely an inch.

Her heart was beating hard in her chest, and she took a long breath through her nose. “You wouldn’t dare.”

Doug held her gaze, then slid his hand up her thigh and pushed his fingers, along with her tights and panties, into her already-sopping sex.

Leanne let out an involuntary groan.

Doug pushed up her skirt with his other hand, gripped the material of her tights in both hands and ripped them open.

Leanne let out a cry of surprise, but then he pulled the gusset of her panties aside and slid his fingers deep inside. Her legs shaking slightly, she pushed her fingers into the long curls of his hair and closed her eyes while he finger-fucked her.

Suddenly he pulled her down next to him and laid her on her back, so she was full length on the bales. Her legs fell open as he undid his belt and pushed his jeans down his thighs.

She only got a brief glimpse of his cock, but it was enough for her to realise it was considerably bigger than anything she’d had before. Leanne didn’t understand how she’d gone from hating him to wanting him in the blink of an eye, but her body felt so alive and she was desperate to have him inside her.

As he positioned himself on the bale between her legs, he paused and looked into her eyes.

She could feel the head of his cock at her outer lips. Maybe he was having second thoughts, or was giving her the chance to stop it from happening. It was nice of him, but not necessary. She placed her hands on his hips. “Fuck me.”

The smile returned to his eyes, the skin around them crinkling in a sexy way. Then he pushed his hips forward and she felt herself widening and stretching.

She let out a grunt as he sank all the way inside her. She closed her eyes and concentrated on the sensation of being completely filled.

He started to fuck her slowly, pulling almost all the way out before sliding all the way back in. He was slow and gentle, which surprised her.

Involuntary moans escaped her lips with each thrust, growing a little louder as his thrusts increased in speed. She wrapped her legs around his and pushed her hands up the inside of his shirt, feeling the muscles in his back as he moved on her. Her breaths got shallower, her moans a little higher in pitch.

He raised himself up on his strong arms and looked into her face.

She bit her lip. She was about to come, and he knew it. He was watching her face as she felt the warmth of her orgasm blossom, his cock the epicentre of all the sensations spreading throughout her body. "Oh god..."

He maintained his speed and intensity as she writhed and groaned and mumbled. Her body seemed to be liquefying around him, her muscles clenching and gripping while turning to hot caramel.

When she was able to open her eyes again, he was smiling down at her. He was in control, and there was nothing she could do about it.

He pulled out and encouraged her to kneel on the floor facing the bales, then pushed her forwards so her chest was resting where she'd just lain. He knelt between her legs and entered her from behind.

She let out another cry as he slammed into her, this time going even deeper than before. His hands gripped her hips as he fucked her with much more force. Each thrust of his hips pushed her forwards. She pressed her hands flat against the wall behind the bales, trying to drive herself back onto his cock.

Suddenly he reached round and down, his fingers rubbing either side of her clit while he continued to pound her from behind. Leanne let out startled cry as she came again, hardly able to believe the way her body was reacting. She felt his rough hands slide up her sweater, push her bra up and squeeze her breasts, pinching her nipples. She pushed herself back to meet each thrust, grunting like a pig as he fucked her.

A groan of disappointment escaped her when he pulled out again. He sat down on the bale next to her, and she looked at his cock. It was dark

and slick with her juices. She wondered if he wanted her to suck him. She was preparing herself to do it when he lifted her easily onto his lap.

She straddled his knees, her skirt bunched up around her waist, her sweater covered in hay. He pushed her sweater up to reveal her breasts and leaned forward, taking a nipple into his mouth.

She let out a sigh, again surprised by his gentleness.

He released her nipple and looked into her eyes. Placing his hands on her waist, he lifted her forwards.

Leanne used her hand to guide his cock inside her, letting out a whimper as her sex sheathed him. Then she opened her eyes and started to ride him.

Doug traced small circles around her nipples with his fingertips. He leaned forward and kissed her, gently, on the forehead.

This surprised her. It wasn't something she'd expected, or particularly wanted. She could justify what she'd done by thinking of it as a lust-fuck. It wasn't the first in her thirteen-year marriage.

"Will you be able to come again?" His voice was soft, intimate.

Leanne wasn't going to admit she'd never been able to come twice before today. She shrugged, shook her head.

He smiled and held her hips, moving her up and down on his cock. "I want you to come again."

She rocked her hips each time he lowered her all the way onto his length. She ground her clit against his pubic bone and closed her eyes as she rode him. His fingers returned to her nipples, and she started to groan.

Doug's breathing was now heavy. "I'm right on the edge, but I'm going to hold off until I feel you come."

She opened her eyes and stared at him. His green eyes seemed to be lit from the inside. It was a struggle to keep her own eyes open, the pleasure rippling through her body becoming too intense to bear.

"It's getting hard to hold it. As soon as I feel your muscles gripping me I'm going to shoot inside you."

Leanne started to sob as she came for the third time. She leaned forward and bit into Doug's neck, his stubble scratching her face. She

placed her mouth over his ear, intending to whisper that he could let go and drench her, but no words would come.

Doug pushed her down and held her there. She felt his cock pulse inside as her contractions gripped him. Then she started bouncing on him, revelling in the feeling of his cock caressing her deep inside.

Doug let out another grunt as she squirmed and ground on him. His eyes narrowed slightly, and he took quick, shallow breaths through his mouth.

Finally they both grew still, and she felt him soften inside her. With their faces just inches apart, they stared at each other. Then Leanne leaned forwards and kissed him on the mouth. She slid her tongue against his—he tasted of mints. His arms encircled her, and they sat kissing gently for a couple of minutes.

Finally, she climbed off and sat next to him. Her tights were laddered all the way down to the feet. She took them off, removing one shoe at a time to protect her feet from the prickly barn floor. She proffered the tights to Doug, who took them without saying a word.

Leanne stood up and pulled her bra back in place, then started picking bits of hay from her sweater.

Doug helped, getting the bits on her back she couldn't reach. "Did you tell me your name?"

She looked over her shoulder at him. "No, I think you were too busy abusing my body to ask."

He tilted his head to one side. "I'm asking now."

"Leanne."

His eyebrows went up slightly, then he nodded. "Leanne. I like that. Do you hyphenate it on the Christmas cards you send to your staff?"

This made her laugh. "Why do you insist on being so fucking rude?"

"It usually gets me laid by the posh women I meet."

She laughed again. "I can't believe it worked for you this time. You need to work on your chat-up lines."

Doug shrugged. "I thought they worked fine."

Leanne dusted off her skirt. “And you need to work on your foreplay.”

“You didn’t need foreplay. I could smell you before I touched you, even over your Chanel.”

Leanne looked at him, a sadness creeping up on her. “I’m going to have to go.”

He nodded. “I know.”

Leanne stood a foot away, looking straight at him. “This should never have happened.”

“I disagree.”

She smiled. Nodded. “I’m happily married.”

“Of course you are.”

“I have a family, and a very nice life.”

Doug nodded again. “I appreciate that.” Then he stepped forward, gently taking a piece of hay from her hair.

She sighed, looked towards the door where her car was parked. “I really have to go.”

Doug led the way out of the building and opened her car door for her.

Avoiding the hole in the ground where the grid cover was still missing, she slid into the driver’s seat. Doug walked over to the corner of the yard and opened the gate for her.

As Leanne steered her car through the gap, she stopped and zipped her window down. “I’ve never had sex like that before.”

He tilted his head to one side and smiled.

She liked his smile a lot. She considered telling him she hadn’t realised she was capable of multiple orgasms, but decided against it.

He leaned closer. “I’ll be thinking about what we did when I’m jerking myself off in my hovel tonight.”

She laughed. “I’m glad you’re not the idiot I took you for.”

“And I’m glad you’re not the bitch I took you for.”

“Goodbye, Doug.”

“Bye, Leanne.”

As she drove slowly along the track, she watched him close the gate in her rear-view mirror. Then she was over the hill and he was out of sight.

Portia and Tilly were standing outside the riding arena looking around when Leanne entered the yard from the internal track. One of the women who ran the school approached her car. “Did you get a bit lost?”

Leanne sighed. “Yes, I took a wrong turn somewhere along the way.”

The girls climbed into the back of the car, chattering to each other without acknowledging her.

The woman laughed. “Did you meet Mr Douglas?”

Leanne’s heart thumped in her chest, wondering if the woman could know what had occurred. “A man called Doug showed me this track...”

“That’s him. Douglas is actually his surname, but everyone calls him Doug.”

“Does he work here, then?”

The woman shook her head. “Sort of. He owns the riding school, and all the land around here.”

Leanne felt a coldness run down her back. “How could he do that?”

“Made a fortune from his computer business when he was in his twenties. Now he just potters about here, driving around on a tractor.”

Leanne nodded dumbly, unable to take in what she’d just been told. She’d soon realised he wasn’t a labourer, but wondered why he hadn’t put her right as to who he actually was. She supposed it didn’t matter—they’d never see each other again.

“Mummy?” Portia sounded confused.

“Yes, darling?”

“You have some straw in your hair.”

“I know. I had to open a gate, and got my feet dirty, too. My shoes are ruined.”

“You’ll need to have a shower before Daddy gets home.”

Leanne looked in the rear-view mirror, startled. She wondered what her daughter had meant, but realised she’d simply been referring to having

hay in her hair and dirty feet. Portia was already back in conversation with Tilly.

Leanne tapped 'home' into the sat nav and settled in for the drive back, the warm wetness inside her panties a reminder of her afternoon's escapades.

THE END



[Delores Swallows](#)

United Kingdom (2016)

About the Author



Delores Swallows has many dirty thoughts, and during his free time he writes them down in the form of stories. Born and bred in the northwest of England, he has a commoner's accent and a bit of a crush on his future queen (Kate, not Camilla!).

His stories often feature petite brunettes, high-heeled shoes and voyeurism. He claims he didn't realise these were obsessions until someone pointed out how often they appear in his work.

Find out more about Delores on his [web site](#), chat on [Twitter](#), or follow his new stories on [Amazon](#). And don't forget to sign up to his [mailing list](#) for a **free story**.

Don't forget your dirty story exclusively available to members of [Delores' mailing list](#).

Also by Delores Swallows



Rolled

She took a sip of wine. "Can I ask you something?"

He sat forward "Yeah."

"It's about me being with Bromley..."

"Oh." He looked deflated, as if resigned to the fact he wouldn't be getting any after all.

"I'm just curious about your feelings. What goes through your mind when you're out here and I'm in the bedroom with Bromley?"

He cast his eyes to the floor. "I try not to think—"

"Come on, don't hold back. For the first time in ages, we're actually talking to each other like we used to. We've had a lovely evening." She adjusted herself in her chair, moving her legs to reveal more of her thighs. "I've even dressed up for you..."

He glanced at her legs, then held her gaze. "I think about how you must look on the bed."

"How do you mean?"

"You know, your face, your body."

Janine was puzzled. "I'm not sure I—"

"I think about your expressions, your body language. I imagine you lying down on the bed and looking up at him." He shrugged, embarrassed.

"You mean when I'm lying on the bed and watching him undress?"

Adam nodded.

“What about when I pass him the condom and watch him roll the rubber down onto his cock?”

“Do you help get him hard?” His voice was little more than a whisper.

She shook her head. “No. By the time he unzips his trousers, he’s got a hard-on.” She saw him swallow, bite his lip.

“And what about you? Does he need to...?” He pushed a shoulder forward in a childish shrug, as if ashamed to use the word *foreplay*.

“No.”

“Why not?”

“I’m always wet enough.”

He nodded, took a gulp of wine.

Janine was enjoying herself. She was wet now, just talking about it. “He dribbles, too. I can see precum all over the head of his cock. It glistens until he rolls the condom on.”

Adam was silent, his eyes a little glazed.

Janine uncrossed her legs, placing both feet on the floor. “When he kneels on the bed, I open my legs for him, like this.” She allowed her knees to fall open. “Do you like me opening my legs for another man?”

He frowned, nodded his head slightly.

She smiled. “At last, you’re being honest. Good.”

Adam put his wine down and slid off the sofa, crawled on his hands and knees across the rug until he was by her feet.

She raised her bum high enough off the chair for him to remove her panties. “Can you imagine my expression when he runs the head of his cock through the wetness of my slit?”



When Janine allows Adam to talk her into visiting a casino to celebrate five years together, she never imagines that a night that starts with so much fun and flirting could end in such despair and debt. Adam doesn't just lose all the money they'd saved, he takes out credit they cannot afford to pay back. They work extra hours and struggle for a month to save up enough for the first payment. Then, it appears, the casino manager has another way the struggling couple could make the interest payments.

Outraged, Janine immediately rejects the indecent proposal. But, despite the sleaziness of the suggestion, she's flattered someone would be prepared to consider giving up that sort of money just for... her, and the thought of allowing a complete stranger to use her body pushes buttons she didn't know she had.

And why does Adam seem so keen she should do it...?

[*Rolled*](#) is available from Amazon



X Flies

Over Andy's shoulder I saw Chrissie had removed her dress and was kneeling on the floor between Mark's legs in her black bra, thong and suspender belt. Her stockings and shoes were still on, and her body was excellent. I couldn't help watching as her head moved up and down in Mark's lap.

Amy was now naked and sitting astride James. Her figure was full, but there was no fat on her at all. I had a very clear view of James's hard-on as she heaved herself up and down on it. This was the first time I'd seen a sex act as a bystander, and it was a weird feeling. The thought of watching other people having sex had never appealed before, but was definitely working for me now.

Andy must have seen me watching the other people. "Would you prefer we went to find somewhere a bit more private?" He looked a bit concerned.

"No, here's fine. But thanks." I was enjoying being in the same room as other copulating couples. It felt suitably naughty.



A collection of four hot stories about the illicit thrill derived from having sex with a stranger.

End of the Line - Kerry's husband wants sexy texts to read during a long train journey, and she obliges—revealing fantasies they'd never discussed face to face. But when he tells her he's lost his phone, she goes a lot further than sending just texts.

Hors d'Oeuvres - English art student, Denny, finds himself sitting opposite a strange couple on a late night train out of Paris. The guy is huge, drunk and sleepy. The girl is tiny, sexy and very forward.

Character Reference - *On the night before her interview Angela takes a mild tranquiliser to calm her nerves, but the only thing relaxed is her inhibitions. Having had very little sleep, she needs to think fast next morning to answer all the awkward questions thrown at her.*

Trade - *Denise's husband assures her his obsession with wife-swapping doesn't mean he wants a different life-partner—and she discovers a short-term trade can be a lot of fun.*

[X Flies](#) is available at Amazon.



A Hotwife's Journey

Her key in the door made his heart race. He listened as she came up the stairs, then held his breath when she walked into the bedroom. He couldn't help staring. Her clothes were twisted, her makeup was smudged, and her hair was dishevelled.

She's fucked someone.

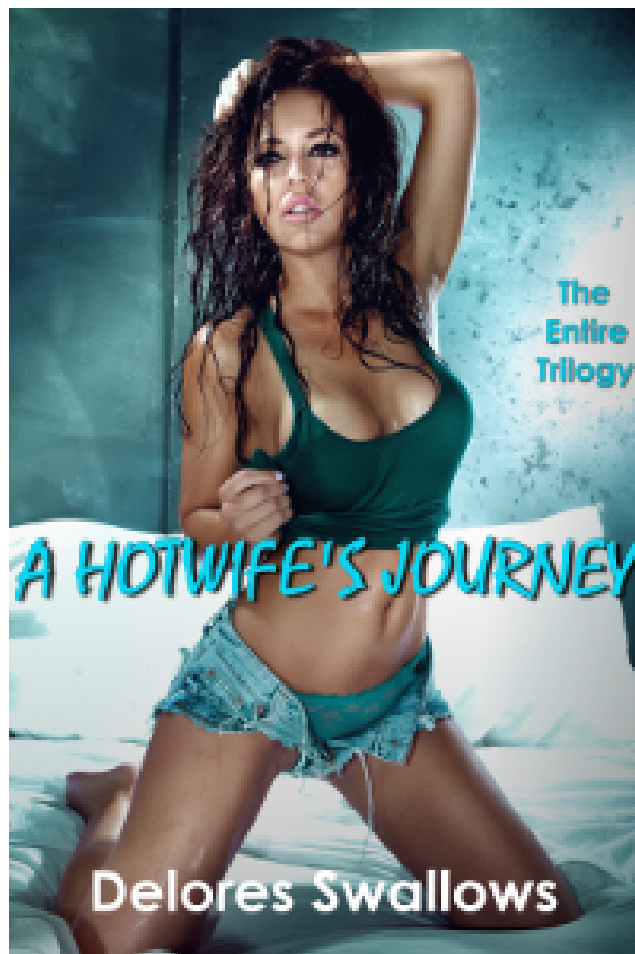
Karen walked to the foot of the bed and looked into his face. "I did it."

He swallowed.

She pulled her top over her head and dropped it on the floor, then pushed her skirt down over her hips and kicked it away. Slowly, she unclipped her bra at the front. As the cups came away, he saw a love bite on one of her breasts. Karen held his gaze as she pushed her thong down her legs and then bent to pick it up, holding it open so he could see the gooey mess soaked into the crotch.

It was another man's cum, and it'd dribbled out of her during the drive home. The guy had deposited it deep in her cunt, and she'd returned home to her pervert husband to show him the evidence.

Nigel ached for her.



A Hotwife's Journey

After her husband's open invitation to become a hotwife, Karen enjoys a variety of surprises and adventures that are hotter than any wife could wish for.

This collection covers her entire journey...

Karen's Open Invitation

Nigel is a lucky man. He has everything a man could want: a successful and beautiful wife, a happy marriage, two wonderful daughters, a nice home and his own business.

So why risk it all just to satisfy his dirty fantasy?

When Karen's throwaway comment about a hot colleague in the Sweden office unlocks the door to his secret desires, he offers her the chance to have a little fun; to mix business with pleasure.

Nigel has fantasised about sharing his wife for a long time. And from the way Karen's been behaving lately, he suspects the idea appeals to her, too.

But there's a big difference between fantasy and reality.

Will she take up his suggestion and have a passionate tryst with a virtual stranger while attending an overseas meeting? Neither know the answer when she leaves for the airport, but she doesn't have to make her decision straight away. She can see how the meeting pans out. After all, it's an open invitation...

Karen's Party Surprise

Nigel is amazed by how Karen's taken to her new role as a hotwife. Not only does she give herself freely to strangers, but she also thrills her husband by giving him all the juicy details he craves when she gets home.

Their sex-life is better than ever.

Nigel realises that an upcoming company get together will mean that they'll be staying in the same hotel as Sean, the first man he ever shared her with. He offers Karen the chance to enjoy another night of passion, and they hatch a plan that could work. But Sean comes up with a counteroffer that's just too good to refuse.

For a wife-sharing couple like Nigel and Karen, it's the ultimate party surprise...

Karen's Holiday Adventures

Life keeps getting better and better for Nigel. His long-held wife-sharing fantasy is now his reality, and he couldn't be happier.

Or at least that's what he thinks until his wife reveals her plans for a break.

Their daughters are going away with their cousin's family, so Karen books a holiday for the two of them—on a Caribbean island. What's more, she promises to make it a fun-filled week where nothing is off-limits.

Under the hot tropical sun of St Lucia, Nigel learns just how hot his hotwife can be.

He's shocked by the diversity of her sexual appetite, but then she did promise him an 'anything goes' holiday adventure...

[A Hotwife's Journey](#) is available from Amazon

